ChatGPT

1) MASTER TAXONOMY (Archetypes)

1. **News Publication / Newspaper:** A site or app for frequently updated news articles and headlines, optimized for quick scanning of news and in-depth article reading.
2. **Magazine / Longform Editorial:** Online publications featuring long-form, feature-style articles or multimedia stories, optimized for immersive reading and visual storytelling.
3. **Documentation / Knowledge Base:** Sites providing technical documentation or help articles (for software, APIs, etc.), optimized for easy navigation of structured reference information and quick lookup.
4. **Wiki / Reference:** Collaborative reference platforms or encyclopedias with many interlinked entries (e.g. Wikipedia), optimized for quick fact look-up and exploration via hyperlinks.
5. **Blog / Creator Article:** Personal or niche-topic websites with chronologically ordered posts (often by one author or a small group), optimized for engaging with individual authors' content and commentary (often with reader comments).
6. **App Marketplace / Storefront (Games/Apps):** Platforms listing software or apps for download/ purchase, often with user reviews, screenshots, and ratings, optimized for app discovery, browsing by category, and quick install/purchase actions.
7. **E-commerce Retail (Physical goods):** Online stores selling tangible products, optimized for product browsing (grid or list of items), filtering/searching, product detail viewing, and a smooth cart-checkout flow.
8. **Streaming Video Platform:** Web or app interfaces for on-demand video content libraries (films, series, user-generated videos), optimized for content discovery (often via personalized recommendations), continuous playback, and minimal interruption.
9. **Music Player / Library App:** Apps or sites to play and manage music collections or streams, optimized for browsing by artist/album, creating playlists, and providing continuous playback with easy control (play/pause/skip).
10. **Email Client:** Applications for reading and sending email (webmail or app), optimized for scanning an inbox list, composing messages, and managing folders/labels efficiently in a high-density list view.
11. **Messaging / Chat App:** Real-time communication interfaces (1-on-1 and group chat), optimized for rapid message sending, reading and reacting to messages, presence indicators, and swift switching between conversations.
12. **Social Feed (Timeline):** Social networking feeds showing a chronological or algorithmic stream of posts from followed users, optimized for endless browsing/scrolling, quick interactions (likes, shares), and content variety (text, images, video).
13. **Short-form Video Feed:** Apps featuring vertically oriented short video clips in an endless feed (e.g. TikTok, Reels), optimized for immersive full-screen viewing with swipe navigation and quick, engaging interactions (like, comment) per video.
14. **Forum / Community:** Discussion platforms with threaded conversations or Q&A (message boards, online forums), optimized for community knowledge-sharing and deep discussions, often including voting or reputation systems for quality content.
15. **Calendar / Scheduling:** Calendar and event scheduling interfaces, optimized for at-a-glance date navigation (month/week/day views), creating events, viewing availability, and managing invites or appointments.
16. **Task / Kanban / To-do:** Productivity tools for task management or project planning (to-do lists, Kanban boards, etc.), optimized for organizing tasks (by priority, status, due date), quick updates (drag-and-drop between columns), and checklist completion.
17. **Notes / Writing App:** Note-taking or writing applications (often cloud-synced across devices), optimized for distraction-free text entry, easy organization of notes (notebooks, tags), and powerful search for retrieval.

18. **Analytics Dashboard:** Interfaces showing data visualizations and metrics (often for business or web analytics), optimized for monitoring key performance indicators at a glance, filtering data via controls, and drilling down into charts/graphs interactively.
19. **Admin Console / Settings-heavy:** Backend administrative UIs (for managing software, systems, or content), optimized for presenting many configuration options (forms, toggles, tables of settings) in a clear structure, and ensuring safe, confirmable actions for critical changes.
20. **Banking / Finance (Consumer):** Consumer-facing banking or personal finance apps, optimized for secure account overview (balances, transaction lists), initiating transfers/payments, and financial insights (spending charts), all with strong trust cues and privacy considerations.
21. **Trading / Market Data:** Platforms for stock/crypto trading or market analysis, optimized for dense information display (real-time prices, charts, order books) and quick trade execution with minimal friction – often including customizable dashboards for active traders.
22. **Travel Booking:** Websites or apps for booking flights, hotels, etc., optimized for multi-step search (with criteria like dates, destination, passengers), comparison of options (prices, ratings), and a streamlined booking and confirmation workflow.
23. **Food Delivery / Restaurant Discovery:** Apps or sites to order food or find dining options, optimized for menu browsing with tempting visuals, location-based search/filtering (cuisine, rating, distance), and a fast checkout/delivery tracking experience.
24. **Education / LMS:** Online learning platforms or Learning Management Systems for courses/training, optimized for delivering course content (videos, readings), tracking progress/quizzes, and encouraging engagement through discussions or gamification (badges, scores).
25. **Developer Platform (API console + docs):** Combined interfaces for developers that typically include API documentation, interactive explorers/consoles, and dashboards (for keys, usage stats), optimized for technical readability (code snippets, clear examples) and quick switching between learning (docs) and doing (testing calls).
26. **Portfolio / Personal site:** Individual's portfolio or personal branding websites (for designers, developers, etc.), optimized for showcasing work or information in a unique personal style – usually simple navigation and a strong focus on visuals or content that reflect the person's identity (often serving as a digital business card).
27. **Landing page:** Single-page marketing websites (often for a product or campaign), optimized for immediately conveying a value proposition and driving a specific call-to-action (sign up, request demo, etc.) with minimal distraction – often characterized by clear sections, bold visuals, and persuasive copy.
28. **Auth / Onboarding flows:** The multi-step interfaces for user sign-up, sign-in, account setup, or initial app onboarding, optimized for getting users through required input steps quickly and painlessly, with clear progress indicators, validation, and maybe some introduction to app features during first-time use.

2) REFERENCE SET (Per archetype)
Below are top reference sites/apps for each archetype, with one sentence on why each is included:

News Publication / Newspaper

- The New York Times — Quintessential newspaper site with a dense, multi-section homepage and classic multi-column layout, known for its rigorous typography and grid system.
- The Guardian — Innovative global news site known for its strong typography (the bespoke "Guardian Egyptian" typeface) and an adaptive, content-heavy design that balances breaking news with long reads.
- BBC News — Leading news organization with a focus on accessibility and clarity, exemplifying the BBC's GEL design language in a mobile-friendly, content-rich layout.
- The Washington Post — Major American newspaper blending a print-inspired hierarchy (notably using the custom "Postoni" headline font) with modern web features and fast loading content.

- Reuters — International news wire service site emphasizing quick headline scanning and market data integration in a clean, no-nonsense interface optimized for speed.
- CNN — 24-hour news site notable for its bold, image-centric front page and prominent video integration, balancing breaking news urgency with an easy navigation of categories.
- Wall Street Journal — Financial news outlet with a disciplined, two-column layout, classic typography, and focus on market data, reflecting a premium, subscription-based news experience.
- Al Jazeera English — International news site with a modern interface and global perspective, balancing text, images, and video while featuring a clean design across its multilingual editions.

Magazine / Longform Editorial

- The New Yorker — Literary magazine site with long-form journalism, distinctive elegant typography, and ample white space, mirroring the magazine's iconic print style and New York sophistication.
- The Atlantic — Digital magazine known for in-depth pieces on culture and politics, presented in a clean, contemporary design that favors readability and a dignified, classic feel.
- Wired — Tech/culture magazine famed for bold design experiments, vibrant color accents, and innovative layouts that reflect its cutting-edge content (often pushing the envelope of web design).
- National Geographic — Features rich visuals and immersive storytelling; the site uses full-width photography and elegant typography to engage readers in long-form articles and photo essays.
- TIME — Iconic news magazine with a web presence balancing timely news briefs and longer features, using straightforward grid layouts and a mix of serif and sans text to maintain a classic yet digital-friendly look.
- Rolling Stone — Pop culture and music magazine site mixing feature stories and news, leveraging impactful imagery and a modern, card-based article grid while maintaining its rock-and-roll attitude through typography and tone.
- Vox — Contemporary digital editorial site known for explanatory journalism and a crisp design, featuring clear typography, bright highlight colors, and card-style story modules that aid readability of complex topics.
- Vanity Fair — Style/culture magazine with a luxurious aesthetic online — high-impact photography, elegant Didot-inspired fonts, and feature-centric layouts convey a sense of glamor and exclusivity.

Documentation / Knowledge Base

- MDN Web Docs — Comprehensive developer documentation with structured content sections, clear code examples, and a universally praised, reader-friendly layout (including features like a sidebar table of contents for quick navigation).
- Microsoft Docs (Learn) — Large-scale technical documentation portal with consistent sidebar navigation, readable sans-serif text, and interactive code snippets/try-it sandboxes, covering everything from Azure to .NET in a unified style.
- Stripe API Documentation — Fintech developer docs known for exceptional clarity and dev-centric design, including concise explanations, copyable code snippets, and an integrated API console that exemplifies best-in-class DX (developer experience).
- Read the Docs (Sphinx-based) — Popular open-source documentation platform providing clean, no-frills docs sites (for Python and other projects) with responsive layouts, an on-page search, and automatic "Edit on GitHub" links, representing a common template for OSS docs.
- Atlassian Confluence (Knowledge Base) — Example of an enterprise knowledge base, featuring hierarchical page trees in a sidebar, straightforward typography, and collaborative features (comments, inline notes) in a clean, intranet-friendly style.

- GitHub Docs — Modern documentation for a major developer platform, offering light and dark theme modes, a mix of sans-serif for body and monospaced text for code, and a top-bar + side-nav combo that scales well to browser or in-app help context.
- AWS Documentation — Massive collection of cloud service docs with multi-level navigation and old-school text-heavy pages; included for its thoroughness and as a representative of ultra-dense technical content (where design takes a backseat to completeness and search functionality).
- Twilio Docs — Telecom API docs featuring quickstart guides and multi-language code snippets, showcasing a developer-friendly style (clear headings, lots of white space, and minimal distraction) that helps users get up and running quickly.

Wiki / Reference

- Wikipedia — The prototypical wiki, allowing collaborative editing on millions of topics; its design is deliberately text-focused and utilitarian, with a simple layout that prioritizes content and a sidebar/table of contents for longer articles.
- Britannica Online — Online encyclopedia with a polished UI and professionally edited content, blending a traditional reference look with web conveniences like multimedia and interactive diagrams, all within a clean, easy-to-read interface.
- wikiHow — How-to wiki with step-by-step instructional articles, unique comic-style illustrations, and a very clear, task-oriented layout (prominent step titles, navigation to each step) to facilitate learning by doing.
- Fandom (Wikia) — Platform hosting fan-created wikis for countless media franchises, featuring extensive navigation menus, theme customizations (often bright and image-heavy per community), and community-centric layouts including forums and collaborative tools.
- Stack Overflow — Q&A reference for programmers with a minimalist, fast-loading interface; it's included as a reference site where community-edited answers serve as a wiki-like knowledge base, with a strict format that highlights top answers and discourages off-topic content.
- Merriam-Webster Dictionary — Online dictionary/reference with quick AJAX search suggestions, clear definitions, pronunciation audio, and a responsive layout for concise information delivery, showcasing how a reference site optimizes text for quick scanning.
- IMDb — Extensive media reference database (movies, TV) with list and gallery views, metadata tables, and user-contributed reviews; illustrates effective presentation of a huge amount of data (casts, dates, ratings) in a reasonably navigable format.
- Investopedia — Financial reference site known for clear definitions and tutorials on finance terms, using a clean content layout with callout boxes for key takeaways and related terms; it blends reference and article formats to educate readers in context.

Blog / Creator Article

- Medium — Popular blogging platform offering a uniform reading experience: clean, large-scale typography, ample white space, and minimal distractions, plus engagement features (claps, highlights) that encourage interaction without cluttering the article.
- WordPress.com Blogs — Representative of countless personal and professional blogs, supporting custom themes but often seen with a classic title + content column layout and a sidebar for archives/tags; included for its ubiquity and flexibility of design.
- Dev.to (Forem platform) — Tech community blogging site with a simple, accessible design (large sans-serif fonts, clear code blocks, dark mode option) that highlights tags and fosters discussion among developers, showing how a blog platform can build community.
- Substack — Newsletter-centric blogging platform where posts are delivered via email and web; it typically uses serif body text and a clean, minimal article page, focusing on content and a prompt to subscribe, thus merging blog and newsletter paradigms.

- Seth Godin's Blog — A personal blog famed for its extreme minimalism (virtually plain-text design, no images or comments) which emphasizes daily content; included to show that a strong voice can carry a site with almost no "design" ornamentation.
- Wait But Why — Independent long-form blog with whimsical hand-drawn illustrations; it employs a basic single-column layout that relies on engaging content and custom graphics, demonstrating a case where personality and content trump sophisticated UI.
- Ghost (Official Blog) — Example of a blog running on Ghost (open-source platform), featuring a modern, minimal UI with robust typography and fast loading times; it's included to illustrate an alternative to Medium/WordPress that many indie bloggers use for a clean look.
- CSS-Tricks — Long-running web design/development blog that pairs article content with an extensive reference section; its design balances a typical blog feed with a resource navigation, making it a hybrid knowledge hub with consistent styling (monospace fonts for code, etc.).

App Marketplace / Storefront (Games/Apps)

- Apple App Store (iOS) — Official iOS app marketplace with curated featured stories, a card-based grid of app listings, and consistent Apple branding emphasizing clean design and trust (user reviews, age ratings, etc., all in a standard format).
- Google Play Store — Android app store featuring category tabs, prominent search, and Material Design elements; it offers personalized recommendations and uses a standard card layout for apps with icon, name, and rating to enable quick browsing.
- Steam — Leading PC gaming storefront with a dense information layout: it combines a carousel of featured games with sidebar filters and community reviews, illustrating a design that caters to browsing and social proof for purchases.
- itch.io — Indie games marketplace with a minimalist, creator-focused design and high customization for developers' pages; it showcases simple grids of game tiles and community ratings while allowing quirky, personalized styling as part of its indie appeal.
- Microsoft Store (Windows Apps) — Windows app store on the web, integrating with the Windows ecosystem; shows tiles for apps/games in a responsive grid and uses Microsoft's Fluent design cues, providing consistency between the OS and web store.
- Product Hunt — Community-driven app and startup discovery platform with a daily leaderboard feed; features upvote counts, comment threads, and product thumbnail cards, blending a social news feel with a marketplace of new apps/products.
- Amazon Appstore — Amazon's Android app marketplace (for Fire devices and others), illustrating a more commerce-oriented approach to app listings with familiar Amazon UI patterns (user star ratings, "Buy/Download" buttons, and use of the Amazon shopping cart for apps).
- F-Droid — Open-source Android app repository with a utilitarian interface and simple list layouts; it emphasizes privacy and transparency, offering a stripped-down design (mostly text lists of apps) as a contrast to commercial app stores.

E-commerce Retail (physical goods)

- Amazon — The largest e-commerce site, emphasizing function over form: ubiquitous search bar, dense product lists with thumbnail + title + rating, and robust filtering options – its design is highly optimized for conversion and familiarity rather than aesthetics.
- Walmart — Big-box retail site with broad inventory; design balances promotional banners with straightforward category navigation and a clean product grid, aiming to make the online experience as intuitive as walking the aisles of a store.
- eBay — Major marketplace combining auctions and buy-it-now listings; features list and gallery views, extensive filtering, and a mix of professional store layouts and user-listed item pages, illustrating a hybrid of retail and peer-to-peer design patterns.

- Target — Retail site known for a slightly more open, modern look than some competitors, with a red-accented theme; it showcases deals prominently and uses a card grid for products, all while maintaining a friendly, clean style consistent with its brand.
- AliExpress — Global marketplace (Alibaba's consumer-facing site) with extremely dense listings and numerous deal banners; it illustrates design for bargain hunters, with many thumbnail images, flash sale timers, and coupon callouts crammed into the interface.
- Etsy — Marketplace for handmade/vintage goods with a warm, craft-inspired aesthetic; uses a card-based product layout with big photos, emphasizes seller profiles and reviews, and features a gently whimsical UI (soft colors, friendly copy) to match its community vibe.
- IKEA — Furniture retailer's site using large imagery and modular content blocks; it emphasizes inspiration (room photos, planners) alongside shopping, and has unique UI patterns for selecting product variants and showcasing dimensions, reflecting the need to convey physical scale.
- Best Buy — Electronics retailer blending standard e-com patterns (grid listings, spec-heavy product pages) with bold promotional content; it includes features like product comparison, Q&A on product pages, and uses a blue/yellow branded UI to reinforce trust in tech expertise.

Streaming Video Platform

- Netflix — Subscription streaming service with a signature dark UI, horizontal scroll *carousels* for content categories, personalized recommendations, profile selection, and seamless auto-play previews; it set many patterns for modern TV/movie browsing UIs.
- YouTube — The massive video platform that combines a search-driven interface with a personalized feed ("Recommended" videos); features endless scrolling on home and category pages, a two-pane watch page (video player + sidebar of suggestions), and a mix of user-generated content tools all in a familiar, utilitarian layout.
- Hulu — Streaming service for TV and movies, showcasing current-season TV content; it uses a dark theme with big image banners, keeps navigation simple (My Stuff, TV, Movies hubs), and provides features like user profiles and live TV integration in a cohesive, entertainment-focused UI.
- Disney+ — Streaming platform with a polished, family-friendly UI and branded content hubs (Disney, Marvel, Star Wars, etc.); employs big promotional sliders, character artwork, and a straightforward content grid, making discovery easy and visually engaging for well-known franchises.
- Amazon Prime Video — Video streaming arm of Amazon with a somewhat utilitarian interface (reflecting Amazon's design language); highlights watchlist and recently watched, integrates purchase/rental options alongside subscription content, and uses a dark UI with Amazon's blue accent on selected elements.
- Twitch — Live-streaming platform (gaming-focused) with a dark theme by default, featuring a multi-column layout (list of followed channels on the left, stream video and chat on the right); real-time interactive elements (live chat, subscriber notifications) define its UI, which prioritizes engagement and quick browsing of live channels.
- HBO Max (Max) — WarnerMedia's streaming app with an interface focusing on curated collections and brand hubs (HBO, DC, etc.); uses large visuals and a purple accented dark theme, with smooth transitions and flourishes that give a premium feel while maintaining usability across TV, web, and mobile.
- Vimeo — Video hosting for creators known for high quality content; the design is clean and minimal, focusing on the video player and staff-picked showcases rather than infinite recommendations, thereby catering to a more professional/portfolio use-case alongside casual browsing.

Music Player / Library App

- Spotify — Dominant music streaming service with a dark-themed web player, a sidebar for navigation (library, playlists), and fluid content areas for discovery (recommendations, radio); its design encourages exploration (e.g., personalized "Discover Weekly" cards) while keeping playback controls persistent and prominent.
- Apple Music (Web) — Apple's music streaming on the web, mirroring their iTunes/Apple Music app: a clean light design with heavy use of album artwork, an emphasis on curated content (editorial playlists, radio), and seamless integration with user libraries, all with Apple's characteristic typography and spacing.
- SoundCloud — Social music platform with a unique waveform player visualization for each track, a light theme, continuous scroll of tracks in feeds, and timed comments on tracks; it blends a music player with social features (likes, reposts, follow) and has a distinctive creator-oriented UI.
- YouTube Music — Google's music streaming service combining official tracks with videos; its interface is simplified compared to YouTube, focusing on album/playlist browsing and personalized mixes, and uses a dark theme by default with visible thumbnails for each song (since many are music videos).
- Pandora — Radio-style streaming known for its simplicity; it has a light theme and centers on station creation (just a search bar to start a station from an artist/song) and an uncluttered now-playing view, reflecting a lean-back listening experience rather than active playlist curation.
- Amazon Music — Part of Amazon's ecosystem, featuring both on-demand streaming and purchase options; design aligns with Amazon's overall style (dark text on light for content sections, but an optional dark player mode), and integrates Alexa and device casting, showing how a music app ties into a larger platform.
- Tidal — High-fidelity music service known for exclusive content and superior audio; uses a slick dark interface with vibrant highlight colors for genres, big artist images, and editorial content, aiming for a premium look that appeals to audiophiles and music enthusiasts.
- Bandcamp — Platform for independent artists selling music directly; features a very minimalist interface with a light theme and simple list/grid of albums, but allows artists to fully customize their album pages (color schemes, background images), resulting in a varied but content-centric browsing experience.

Email Client

- Gmail — The most-used web email, featuring a tabbed inbox (optional category tabs), conversation threading that stacks emails neatly, powerful search, and integration of chat/meet, all within Google's clean Material Design approach to a complex app.
- Outlook.com — Microsoft's consumer webmail with a three-pane layout (folder list, message list, reading pane) reminiscent of desktop Outlook; it offers robust keyboard shortcuts, a focused inbox feature, and integrates calendar/contacts, demonstrating a comprehensive PIM (personal info manager) on the web.
- Yahoo Mail — Legacy webmail with a portal-like approach (often showing news snippets on the mail dashboard), rich theme customization, and a fairly traditional inbox interface; included for its large user base and to contrast its more colorful, content-mixed design with Gmail's simplicity.
- ProtonMail — Privacy-focused email with end-to-end encryption; the interface is simple and modern (with optional dark theme) akin to Gmail but with extra security indicators, and it deliberately avoids ads or data-driven content, reinforcing its secure positioning through design minimalism.
- iCloud Mail (Apple) — Apple's web email client, reflecting the desktop Mail app's clean, no-frills design: light gray aesthetic, straightforward two-pane layout on large screens (mailbox list and

emails), and subtle use of typography, showing Apple's consistency in user experience across devices.
- Hey — Innovative email service by Basecamp rethinking inbox workflows (with concepts like The Screener, Imbox, Paper Trail); its design is opinionated and minimal, with bold sans-serif text and clear sections that guide users through its unique triage system, representing a fresh take on email UX.
- Zoho Mail — Business-oriented webmail with an ad-free, professional interface; includes advanced features like integrated chat and a suite of productivity apps, all within a familiar email layout (folders on left, list in middle, reading pane on right), illustrating how an all-in-one suite keeps email at its core.

Messaging / Chat App

- Slack — Workplace chat with a robust web app: features persistent channel lists on the left, a message pane with rich formatting and threads, and a clean, flat design that balances information density with clarity (and playful touches like emoji reactions and Slack's distinctive loading messages).
- Microsoft Teams — Enterprise communication hub integrating chat, video meetings, and file collaboration; the web app mirrors the desktop client's layout (teams/channels list, chat thread, and a top bar of apps), which is busy but functional, showing how an all-in-one tool organizes myriad features.
- Discord — Community chat platform originally for gamers; the web interface (and client) uses a dark theme, with servers and channels listed on the left and chat on the right. It supports voice and video channels in the UI, and uses playful touches (custom emoji, role colors) while maintaining a clear hierarchy in text channels.
- WhatsApp Web — Browser-based client for the popular mobile messenger, reflecting a simple two-column layout (chat list on the left, current chat on the right) with minimal UI chrome; it brings the mobile experience to desktop with features like drag-and-drop media and voice notes, adapted to keyboard/mouse.
- Telegram Web — Fast, secure messaging app's web version; features a clean UI similar to WhatsApp's (chat list + active chat), but with Telegram's signature touches like sticker sets, and cloud-synced media accessible in a sidebar. It demonstrates consistency with its mobile app in a responsive web format.
- Facebook Messenger (Web) — Web interface for Messenger, focusing on one-on-one and group chats. It presents a contact list and conversation pane, with support for rich media, voice/video calls, and emoji reactions, essentially providing the Facebook chat experience without the rest of Facebook around it.
- WeChat (Web) — Web client for China's ubiquitous messaging "super-app". It requires scanning a QR code to log in, then offers basic chat functionality. Its design is simple (chat list + chat view), as many of WeChat's more advanced features (mini-programs, payments) are mobile-only, but it's included to show a global messaging product adaptation on web.
- Signal (Desktop/Web) — Privacy-first messaging with a straightforward interface; the desktop app (built on Electron, essentially web tech) has a minimalist design with an emphasis on encryption indicators. No fancy extras – the UI is bare-bones (chat list, chat view, a few icons) to avoid any confusion about its purpose: secure text and calls.

Social Feed (timeline)

- Facebook — The classic social network feed mixing text, images, videos, and link previews in an algorithm-driven timeline; it features a top-heavy navigation (search, profile, menus), a multi-column layout on desktop (feeds, sidebars for contacts/trending), and interactive controls on each post (Like, Comment, Share), embodying the all-purpose social media design.

- Twitter (X) — Primarily text-centric timeline (though now with more images and videos) focusing on short posts. It's known for its continuous scroll feed, minimal tweet containers, and lightweight interactions (heart, retweet) that happen instantly. The interface is very feed-centric with trends on the side, demonstrating high information density while remaining visually spare.
- Instagram — Visual-first feed of photos and short videos; uses a simple single-column scroll on mobile and a 3-column grid profile view. It minimizes text (aside from usernames and captions), letting imagery drive the experience, and includes story bubbles at the top and a very minimal navigation, illustrating focus on content consumption over external links.
- LinkedIn — Professional social feed with posts about career updates, industry news, etc. The layout is similar to Facebook's (top nav, feed in center, sidebars with additional info) but the tone is more formal. It shows how design patterns carry over to business context: e.g., slightly more subdued color scheme, and microcopy like "Say congrats" prompts to encourage interaction in a professional manner.
- Pinterest — Image-based discovery feed using a Masonry-style grid layout that is dynamically arranged. It emphasizes visuals (pins) with minimal text, and supports infinite scroll within topic feeds and boards. The design encourages collecting and browsing by showing many items at once and relying on visual differentiation, exemplifying a non-linear feed where users might click to zoom into details.
- Mastodon (Web client) — Decentralized social network with an interface reminiscent of TweetDeck: advanced web apps show multi-column layouts (e.g., one for timeline, one for notifications, etc.). This showcases an alternative approach to social feeds, where power users can have several streams side by side. Simpler Mastodon web interfaces use a single-column feed (similar to Twitter's basic view) with the twist of multiple servers/communities, which is handled by slightly more complex onboarding and subtle server branding in the UI.

Short-form Video Feed

- TikTok — The dominant short-video app, offering a full-screen **vertical video** feed on mobile (and a similar centered video player on web); the UI is minimal overlay (like, comment, share buttons on the right) to maximize video immersion, and navigation is primarily the continuous swipe up for next video. It's included as the blueprint of the genre, where the content itself is the interface.
- Instagram Reels (Instagram) — Instagram's short video feature, integrated into the main app; it presents a similar swipeable video feed with creator info and audio track info overlayed. It leverages Instagram's existing UI for engagement (heart, comment, send icons) and uses the familiar IG design language while cloning the TikTok interaction model.
- YouTube Shorts (YouTube) — YouTube's answer to short-video format, accessible via the main site/app; it uses a vertically scrolling feed of micro-videos within the YouTube interface, allowing quick swipe navigation on mobile and showing typical YouTube elements (like/dislike, comments) in a condensed form. It demonstrates how a platform known for longer content adapts to bite-sized videos.
- Snapchat (Spotlight/Stories) — Pioneer of the Stories format; while Stories are user-selected and ephemeral, **Spotlight** on Snapchat is a short-video feed akin to TikTok. The app (mobile-only primarily) uses quick tap and swipe interactions in a full-screen video interface with minimal UI, and while the web version is limited, Snapchat's influence via the vertical storytelling format is seen across the industry.
- Vine (archived) — Defunct platform that popularized 6-second looping videos; included for historical context as it set early design patterns for short-video UIs (simple vertical feed, loop indicator, minimal controls). Vine's legacy lives on in how modern short-form video apps emphasize brevity and looping, although Vine itself had a simpler UI given its time (2013–2016) and now exists only in archive form.

- Triller — An alternative short-form video platform focusing on music and social challenges; its interface closely mimics TikTok's core pattern (swipe for next, on-screen engagement buttons) but is included to show the standardized nature of this archetype's design – nearly all entrants converge on the fullscreen swipe model with minor stylistic differences.

Forum / Community

- Reddit — Major discussion platform featuring topic-based communities (subreddits). The UI presents posts in a scrollable list with voting arrows and comment counts, either in a dense classic view or a card view; included as the archetype of modern forums, complete with threaded comments and community moderation tools.
- Quora — Q&A community where questions and answers are displayed in a feed and on individual pages; it combines a clean reading layout for long answers with social features like upvotes and follow buttons, representing a hybrid of forum and knowledge base with an emphasis on reputable responses.
- Stack Exchange (Stack Overflow) — Network of Q&A communities (Stack Overflow for programming being the flagship) with a strict format: question lists with vote counts and tags, and detailed Q&A pages that highlight the top answer. Its design is minimal and fast, prioritizing content and correctness, making it a gold standard for expert communities.
- Hacker News — Ultra-minimalist tech news forum by Y Combinator: just text links in a single-column list and basic nested comments in a sparse layout. It eschews all modern styling, demonstrating that functionality (fast load, simple interaction) can trump visual design in fostering an active community of a certain kind.
- Discourse (forum platform) — A modern open-source forum platform (exemplified by its own Meta forum) that offers features like infinite scrolling, dynamic loading of new posts, real-time notifications, and expandable/collapsible replies. Its design is clean and semi-flat, with user avatars and badges bringing a bit of color, representing the state-of-the-art in forum UX.
- vBulletin (Legacy Forums) — A once-popular proprietary forum software; typical vBulletin forums have a traditional paginated thread layout, user signatures, and a relatively cluttered interface by today's standards. Included to show the old-school forum style which persists in many communities (with categories, thread lists, and dated look) and how it contrasts with newer solutions.
- Ars Technica OpenForum — Longstanding tech community forum (based on phpBB in its "Civis" incarnation) showcasing a classic threaded discussion with pagination, moderation highlighting, and a no-nonsense interface. It's an example of a niche expert community sticking with a proven forum design that its users are accustomed to.

Calendar / Scheduling

- Google Calendar — Widely used online calendar with day/week/month views, quick event creation via clicking and dragging, and seamless integration with Gmail (e.g., auto-adding events). Its design is clean and utilitarian, with a responsive grid of dates and a clear blue accent for current day/events, illustrating the de-facto pattern for digital calendars.
- Microsoft Outlook Calendar (Web) — Part of Office 365's web suite, offering a full-featured calendar with sharing and meeting scheduling. It mirrors the Outlook desktop look and feel (including colored category labels and a detailed scheduling assistant for meetings), showing how enterprise calendar needs (like free/busy grid views) are handled on the web.
- Calendly — Popular scheduling tool for coordinating meetings with others; showcases a clean booking interface that lets invitees pick a time slot from a simplified calendar view. It's optimized for conversion – minimal distractions, just a calendar and a form – and demonstrates best practices for an **appointment scheduling** pattern (including automatic time zone detection and confirmation screens).

- [Doodle](#) — Scheduling poll service with a focus on simplicity: presents dates/times in a grid where participants can mark availability. The design is bare-bones but very clear (checkboxes in a table), illustrating a specialized use of calendar UI for group scheduling rather than personal event management.
- [Fantastical (Flexibits)](#) — A premium calendar app known for natural language event entry and beautiful design (mostly on macOS/iOS; the website showcases its features). Included as a reference for cutting-edge calendar UX (e.g., combining reminders and events, seamless online meeting integrations) and to note that while its web interface is limited, its influence (like smooth animations, delightful touches) is felt in calendar design discussions.
- [Cron Calendar](#) — A newer calendar app (now part of Notion) with a sleek, modern interface and features like multiple time zone display and keyboard-centric controls. It's mentioned as an example of how calendar apps are evolving (often providing a web version using Electron or similar) with design touches aimed at power users, hinting at the future of this archetype's UX (blending calendar with to-do and scheduling analytics).

Task / Kanban / To-do

- [Trello](#) — Pioneering Kanban board tool with a simple drag-and-drop card interface; features columns (lists) representing stages, and cards for tasks that can be moved between lists. Its design is very approachable (toy-like details, unlimited scroll boards) and taught millions the Kanban paradigm, hence a gold standard reference.
- [Asana](#) — Project management tool with multiple views (list, board, timeline) and a clean, colorful aesthetic. Known for its playful touches (celebratory unicorn animations on task completion [1] [2]) and strong team collaboration features (assignments, comments), it exemplifies a comprehensive yet user-friendly task system.
- [Jira](#) — Atlassian's issue tracker, ubiquitous in software teams. The design is information-dense and configurable, including backlog lists, Scrum/Kanban boards, and detailed issue pages with many fields. It shows enterprise-grade complexity – powerful, but sometimes overwhelming – and has influenced many lighter tools as a contrast to avoid (thus a useful reference).
- [Monday.com](#) — Work OS platform known for a highly visual, grid-based approach to tasks (essentially a flexible spreadsheet with status pills, person columns, etc.). Its bright, modular UI demonstrates how task management can be reimagined beyond boards, and how onboarding and templates can lower the learning curve for managing anything (from tasks to CRM) via a customizable table interface.
- [Notion (Tasks in Notion)](#) — All-in-one workspace that includes databases which can serve as to-do lists or Kanban boards. Notion's flexible block editor lets users view tasks as a simple list, a board, a calendar, etc., all with a minimal aesthetic. It's included to show the intersection of note-taking and task management in a highly customizable environment that favors simplicity and user-defined structure.
- [Basecamp](#) — Project management emphasizing simplicity and team communication. Its tasks (To-dos) are presented as plain lists within projects, with checkboxes and assignments, intentionally avoiding complexities like dependency tracking. Basecamp's opinionated, text-first design (with quirky illustration mascots) is a counterpoint to feature-heavy tools, championing focus on what's due.
- [Todoist](#) — Popular personal task manager with a minimalist list interface, natural language input for due dates ("tomorrow at 5pm"), and gamification via Karma points. It exemplifies a cross-platform to-do app that scales from simple grocery lists to complex projects, all in a clean, distraction-free UI that encourages daily review.
- [Microsoft To Do](#) — Personal task app evolved from Wunderlist; features a light, airy design with themed backgrounds, "My Day" focus list, and easy dragging to reorder tasks. It integrates with Outlook and Teams, representing the consumer-friendly face of Microsoft's task ecosystem, and

shows design considerations for approachability (friendly illustrations, clear "Add a task" prompts) in to-do apps.

Notes / Writing App

- Evernote — One of the original digital notebook apps (web and desktop clients), with a web UI that features a notebook panel, note list, and editor area. It introduced many to the idea of rich-text notes synced in the cloud. The design includes powerful search (including in-image text), tagging, and a fairly busy UI reflecting its plethora of features (from reminders to integrations).
- Microsoft OneNote (Web) — Notebook-style note app that mimics a binder with section tabs and pages. The web version offers full editing with ink support. Its design uses a free-form canvas for notes (you can click anywhere to type, like on paper), illustrating a more unstructured approach to note-taking, suitable for mixed media and handwriting – distinct from linear document-style notes.
- Google Keep — Simple sticky-notes-inspired app; uses a grid of color-coded note "cards" that can be rearranged. It's very lightweight in features, focusing on quick capture (notes or checklists) and is often cited for its simplicity and ease of use, showing an alternative to complex notebooks – essentially a digital Post-it board with search.
- Apple Notes (iCloud) — Apple's note app accessible via web, reflecting the iOS/macOS Notes app's clean interface. It supports basic rich text, checklists, and image attachments within a plain canvas. The design is spartan (light background, simple list of notes) but effective, demonstrating how a familiar mobile app translates to a web environment with almost no extra chrome.
- Notion (Notes use-case) — Notion is often used for note-taking and personal knowledge bases. It demonstrates a block-based editor that allows mixing text, images, databases, and embeds, all within a minimal interface that can fade into the background. Notion's rise shows a trend toward *convergence* of notes, docs, and wikis, with a focus on customization (users often create aesthetic templates, dashboards, etc.).
- Obsidian — A Markdown-based knowledge base app (notes stored locally as .md files) known for its graph view of note connections. Its design caters to power users: a dark theme, pane splitting for multiple notes at once, and support for community plugins. It represents the "second brain" movement (Roam/Obsidian) where bidirectional linking and graph visualization influence the UX significantly.
- Roam Research — Influential note-taking tool introducing networked thought and daily notes. The UI is outline-centric (indentation is structure) with every paragraph having an anchor for linking. It's text-first with few styling options, focusing on **backlinks** and quick linking (`[[Like This]]` syntax) to build a web of notes. Its novel approach has impacted many subsequent note apps and is a reference point for "knowledge graph" style UX.
- Bear — Aesthetic Markdown note app for Mac/iOS; known for beautiful typography, theme options, and hashtag organization. It's included as an example of a smaller-scale notes app that emphasizes *writing pleasure* – it uses proportional sans-serif for body text (unusual for monospaced-focused Markdown editors) and offers subtle UI animations, appealing to writers who value both form and function.

Analytics Dashboard

- Google Analytics — Standard web analytics dashboard (for websites/apps) featuring an overview page with key metrics and many detailed reports. It illustrates the challenge of simplifying lots of data: GA uses cards with charts for overview and left navigation for deeper reports, with careful use of color to indicate performance vs previous period [3]. (Note: GA4's redesign in 2020s shows an even more card-based, customizable approach.)

- Mixpanel — Product analytics platform with a focus on user event flows; its interface is more exploratory, allowing users to construct queries via a GUI. It showcases a modern SaaS dashboard style: clean sans-serif text, generous whitespace, and interactive charts that update in real-time as filters are changed, catering to non-technical product managers as well as analysts.
- Tableau Online — Business intelligence tool known for powerful data visualization; the web interface lets users interact with complex charts and dashboards. It exemplifies a richly interactive UI: users can hover to highlight data, filter via clicking on chart elements, and even author dashboards in-browser. The design challenge it meets is combining a *design tool* with a *consumption dashboard* in one product.
- Microsoft Power BI (Web) — Microsoft's BI platform delivering interactive dashboards via the web. It shows a tile-based dashboard layout (multiple visualizations arranged in a grid) and offers natural language query ("Ask a question about your data…"). The styling follows Microsoft's Fluent design with bright accent colors and modern icons, representing the enterprise polished end of analytics UIs.
- Grafana — Open-source dashboard platform commonly used for IT monitoring (e.g., server metrics). Known for highly customizable graph panels, often set against a dark background (to better show colored lines), Grafana's web UI demonstrates effective use of color and grid in high-density dashboards and supports advanced user tweaks (queries, thresholds) in-panel. It's a reference for real-time monitoring UX (where users may be staring at charts for anomalies).
- Amplitude — Product analytics for growth teams, offering user segmentation, funnels, retention charts, etc. The UI emphasizes an easy-to-use query builder and smooth charts; it has a relatively flat learning curve compared to older BI tools. Amplitude's design language (vibrant purple and blue, friendly illustrations onboarding) shows how analytics tools are being made more approachable and less "stodgy" to attract a broader user base beyond data scientists.
- Datadog — Monitoring and analytics for infrastructure and applications; its web UI handles extremely high data density (e.g., real-time logs streams, combined metrics dashboards). It often employs a dark theme for charts to maximize contrast, and packs configurable widgets tightly. It's included to illustrate how complex, rapidly updating data (CPU graphs, error lists) can be arranged for DevOps users, with trade-offs in simplicity.
- Looker Studio (Google) — Formerly Google Data Studio, it allows creation of custom data dashboards/reports. Its interface is part editor, part viewer – more akin to presentation software or a design tool, where you drag charts, apply data sources, etc. It's a good example of a **user-customizable** dashboard platform and highlights the need for balancing flexible layout/design controls with template simplicity for end viewers.

Admin Console / Settings-heavy

- AWS Management Console — Amazon's cloud services console with an extremely dense, service-driven navigation (hundreds of services in a mega-menu). The UI is utilitarian – lots of forms, tables, and minimal styling – focusing on function over form. It exemplifies the complexity of an admin UI that has grown organically: inconsistent sub-console designs, powerful but overwhelming. (Still, search and a favorites bar help users find services.)
- Google Cloud Console — Google's cloud platform admin UI; it shows a more unified design approach (Material-inspired) compared to AWS. Features a persistent left nav with icons for major services, an integrated top search bar, and right-pane flyouts for settings. It demonstrates how thoughtful grouping and clean icons can slightly tame a very complex interface, plus includes niceties like a **Web CLI** (Cloud Shell) right in the interface.
- Azure Portal — Microsoft's cloud portal, notable for its **dashboard** that users can personalize with tiles (monitoring graphs, resource shortcuts). It uses a flexible column layout and Blade UI (sliding panels) for drilling down into settings. This showcases a design trying to accommodate

both high-level monitoring and deep configuration, with a theme consistent with Windows 10/11's Fluent design (and themeable in dark/light).
- WordPress Admin Dashboard — Classic website CMS admin interface, with a menu of content types and settings in a sidebar and content area on the right. It's ubiquitous for site management (posts, pages, plugins, etc.) and demonstrates a relatively consistent, extensible design (plugins can add menu items) that balances simplicity for bloggers with advanced features for developers, all in a tabbed, form-based UI.
- cPanel — Web hosting control panel widely used on servers. It presents a grid of icons for categories (Files, Databases, Email, etc.) each leading to forms and tools. The design feels a bit dated (icon-heavy, skeuomorphic touches) but is very task-focused. It's a prime example of an old-school admin UI aimed at semi-technical users managing websites, where clarity of categories and reliability trump any modern aesthetic.
- Salesforce Lightning Experience — Enterprise CRM admin with exhaustive settings and data management screens. It shows a nav bar with core objects (Accounts, Leads…), lots of configurable list views and forms, and a component-based page layout. The Lightning redesign brought a more modern, unified look (with whitespace and gentle icons) to what is otherwise a beast of an interface. It exemplifies tackling extreme complexity with modular design system principles, while still inevitably having steep learning curve due to sheer scope.
- Shopify Admin — E-commerce store admin interface used by merchants. It has a clean, sidebar navigation (Orders, Products, Customers, etc.) and content pages that often include graphs and tables. It's known for its well-crafted design (Polaris design system), providing a friendly, almost mobile-app simplicity to tasks like adding products or fulfilling orders. Good reference for blending data (sales charts) with actions (add product forms) elegantly.
- Jenkins CI — Automation server with a very spartan UI (largely unchanged for years): essentially a list of projects and configuration pages with lots of checkboxes and text fields. It's open-source and highly functional but visually barebones. Included to show the contrast in some admin tools where developer-users tolerate or even prefer a basic interface as long as it's powerful and fast – highlighting that sometimes **function over form** is an acceptable trade-off in admin UIs.

Banking / Finance (Consumer)

- Chase Online Banking — Major US bank with a robust online banking site focusing on account overview, transaction history tables, and quick transfer/bill-pay buttons. The design uses high contrast (dark text on white, Chase's blue accents), straightforward navigation (accounts, payments, etc.), and ample security cues (logout timers, photo verification) to optimize for trust and clarity.
- Bank of America Online — Consumer banking portal emphasizing a clean dashboard of accounts with balances and due dates, and a prominent **security** area (last login, Secure Messaging). Its design, while a bit conservative, uses a responsive card layout for different account types and lots of informational tooltips, reflecting how banks aim to reassure users while presenting a lot of data.
- Wells Fargo — Traditional bank site with a somewhat dated design but very clear segmentation of services. The online banking section uses simple tables for transactions and basic form-style pages for things like transfers. It's included to represent the many banks that haven't fully modernized visually but maintain consistency and simplicity to cater to less tech-savvy customers.
- Revolut — Digital-first bank (neobank) with a sleek design in its app and web portal; known for *flat design*, playful colors, and features like budget analytics and cryptocurrency trading within the same UI. Revolut's web interface (for some functionality like management) and marketing site both exude modernity and cater to a millennial audience, highlighting how newer financial apps differentiate via design.

- Monzo — UK-based digital bank focusing on an excellent mobile UX with bright branding (hot coral accents). Its web presence is limited (mainly account recovery) as it's mobile-first, but it's included as an influential archetype: in design discussions, Monzo is known for its tone of voice (friendly, transparent microcopy) and clean, *human* design that other banking apps emulate in their own interfaces.
- N26 — European digital bank with a minimalist aesthetic; their web banking app (for desktop) uses plenty of whitespace, simple icons, and a focus on essential info, much like their mobile app. It demonstrates how a banking UI can be decluttered when built from scratch – e.g., a clear timeline of transactions with icons, and contextual menus for actions, rather than dense menus.
- PayPal — Global payments platform with a financial dashboard showing balances, recent activity, and quick actions (Send, Request money). The UI has evolved to be more app-like (cards for each currency balance, a prominent "Send" button, etc.), bridging between banking and commerce. It shows the importance of clear CTAs and user-friendly language (e.g., "Send" instead of "Transfer") when dealing with money movements for a broad user base.
- Mint — Popular personal finance tracker aggregating multiple accounts. Its dashboard interface emphasizes charts for spending trends, budget categories with visual gauges, and alerts (e.g., "Bill due" or "Over budget") in a user-friendly manner. Mint's design (pastel colors, approachable illustrations) is often cited for making financial data *understandable*, setting a standard for finance apps to be less intimidating.

Trading / Market Data

- Robinhood — Commission-free trading app known for its sleek, minimalist interface targeting novice investors. The web app shows a clean chart of a stock with minimal tools (one-click buy/sell), uses a dark or light theme with simple line graphs, and celebrates motion (confetti for first trade). It's a reference point for how simplifying the UX (sometimes controversially so) can drive engagement in trading.
- E*TRADE — Established online brokerage with a web platform offering rich tools like customizable stock screeners, option chain tables, and multi-tab research pages. The design is more traditional (lots of data in grid formats, some Flash or HTML5 chart tools) reflecting experienced traders' needs, and stands in contrast to newer apps through its complexity and depth of features exposed.
- Charles Schwab — Brokerage site blending modern and legacy design elements. The client account interface has been modernized with simpler navigation and dashboards, but detailed areas (e.g., trade ticket, research reports) still follow utilitarian designs. It's included to show an incumbent adapting: adding responsive charts, simplifying menus, but still serving an audience used to older layouts.
- Yahoo Finance — Widely used free market data site with stock quote pages that include interactive charts, news, and community discussion. Its design is content-heavy (lots of modules on a single page), but it's logically organized (chart up top, stats next, news below) and is a go-to for many casual market followers. Yahoo Finance demonstrates balancing **timely content** (news headlines) with **historical data** on one page.
- TradingView — Advanced charting platform and social network for traders; renowned for its in-browser candlestick charts that users can annotate and for sharing community scripts/ideas. The UI is highly interactive (dragging charts, adding technical indicators via a toolbar) and fairly dense. It's effectively a web-based Bloomberg-lite, showing how far web tech can go in delivering a desktop-app-like trading interface (with WebGL charts, etc.).
- Coinbase — Leading cryptocurrency exchange with a consumer-friendly interface: it blends a simple account dashboard (portfolio value, easy buy/sell buttons) with educational prompts. The design uses lots of white space and approachable language to demystify crypto. It also provides

more advanced trading views on Coinbase Pro, illustrating a company offering dual UIs (beginner vs advanced) under the same brand.

- Binance — Major crypto trading platform with both a simplified interface and a professional interface. The **Binance Pro** web UI is akin to a traditional trading terminal (depth chart, order book, recent trades, all next to a candlestick chart) with a dark theme – a good example of maximum data density for those who need it. The **Binance Lite** (or Buy Crypto) flows are much simpler, showing the split UX for different user segments.
- Bloomberg (Markets) — Financial news and data portal known for market summaries and stock pages. While the actual Bloomberg Terminal is a separate product (with its iconic black-and-orange interface), Bloomberg's public web Markets section shows lots of market data (index charts, top movers) interspersed with news in a clean, grid-based layout. It's a useful reference for integrating real-time data with editorial content in a dashboard-style page.

Travel Booking

- Booking.com — Global hotel booking site with a utilitarian, high-conversion design: a prominent search box, filter-heavy results pages, and urgency cues (limited availability warnings). It's known for extensive A/B-tested UI elements (e.g., yellow "Order now" buttons, subtle animations on price drop alerts) all aimed at nudging users to book.
- Expedia — Large travel agency site handling flights, hotels, packages. It illustrates managing a complex multi-step flow: from a unified search form to tabbed result pages for different components to a step-by-step checkout. Expedia's design uses a lot of white and blue, with clear iconography (airplane, hotel) to help users navigate bundles and options.
- Airbnb — Home rental platform known for its clean aesthetic and emphasis on high-quality property images. The search results combine a map with listings, employing a card design for each property with seamless hover highlighting on the map. Airbnb's use of personable microcopy, wish lists (hearts), and sparse use of lines (lots of whitespace) has influenced many modern travel site designs to feel more "lifestyle" and less "database".
- Skyscanner — Metasearch engine for flights (and hotels/cars), with a minimal interface focusing on flight search. Known for flexible date searching (a chart view of cheapest days) and straightforward results display that aggregates many airlines. Its design proves that even data-heavy results (lots of flight times/prices) can be presented clearly with good typography and spacing.
- Kayak — Another major metasearch travel site offering a unified interface for flights, hotels, car rentals. Kayak's results pages use dynamic filters and a "loading more results" auto-scroll. They also experiment with UX like price prediction (a little modal suggesting "Wait or Buy"). It's a reference for how slight differences (like a more modern filter bar, or exploratory features) can differentiate an interface in a crowded market.
- TripAdvisor — Travel reviews and booking aggregator, combining user-generated content with booking options. The design prominently features traveler photos and review snippets on hotel/restaurant pages, alongside meta info. It has to balance content and commerce: e.g., show authentic reviews (social proof) but also "Book Now" buttons. Its interface, while a bit busy, demonstrates the effective use of tabs or accordions to separate reviews, Q&A, and details, and highlights the power of crowd-sourced content in influencing UI (so many reviews that filtering and sorting become key UI elements).
- Delta Airlines — Example of a major airline's direct booking site. It illustrates a custom workflow: multi-step forms for flight search (with seat selection UIs), integrated upsells (choose fare class, credit card offers), and travel-specific UI like an interactive seat map. Airlines often have their own design language; Delta's is fairly modern, using their red accent and lots of iconography, and it shows the complexity of handling date-pickers, time selection, and validation errors in a single cohesive flow.

- Google Travel — Google's integrated trip planner UI (pulling info from Flights, Hotels, and user itineraries). It showcases a very data-driven approach: using Google's knowledge graph to highlight popular things to do, bundling a user's bookings into an automatically generated timeline, etc. Visually it's Material Design, with cards and tabs, and it's interesting how it aggregates services that are usually separate, into one interface (demonstrating context-based UI – e.g., a hotel card that shows price from various booking sites via metasearch without leaving Google).

Food Delivery / Restaurant Discovery

- Uber Eats — Food delivery app offshoot of Uber, focusing on browsing nearby restaurants with compelling food imagery. The interface uses card carousels ("Popular near you", "Pick Again" for reorders) and quick-access categories ("Mexican", "Burgers"). It's optimized for rapid filtering and ordering with minimal typing. The design is clean but leverages strong visuals (photos of dishes) since hunger is best stimulated by images.
- DoorDash — Major food delivery platform; the interface emphasizes speed and convenience (e.g., showing **estimated delivery time** and cost up front in restaurant lists). It has features like sorting by "Under 30 min" or "Free Delivery" via chips, and order tracking once you've ordered (including a map with the driver). Design-wise, it's similar to Uber Eats with a slightly different color palette (red) and some different iconography, illustrating how convergent this space is.
- Grubhub — Food delivery marketplace with a more list-oriented design. It highlights deals and tends to have a busier interface (with things like coupon banners, promotional carousels). Grubhub's design shows the legacy of being one of the first in the space – functional but perhaps less streamlined than newer entrants – yet it's instructive for showing standard patterns like persistent bottom nav on mobile (Home, Search, Orders, Account) that virtually all these apps use.
- Deliveroo — International delivery service (popular in UK/EU) with a slick, modern site and app. It uses a **sticky horizontal filter** for cuisines and dietary options and has a signature teal accent color. Deliveroo's restaurant menus are particularly well-designed, often with section anchor links and attractive item photos, setting a bar for menu readability.
- Just Eat — Another global player (brand varies by country, e.g., Takeaway.com in NL) with a bright, inviting design. It's included to represent the non-US perspective: its UI is similar (search + list of restaurants) but with local touches (like showing popular dishes right in the search results). It reinforces that this archetype's design is fairly standardized worldwide, with only minor cultural tweaks (colors, imagery).
- Yelp — Primarily a restaurant discovery and reviews platform (not focused on delivery, though it offers orders via partners). Yelp's design features list and map views, star ratings, price filters, and a lot of user photos and reviews. It's a reference for the **discovery** aspect (finding where to eat out) rather than delivery – the archetypal local search layout that many follow.
- OpenTable — Restaurant reservation system focusing on date/time slot selection in a table format for each restaurant. The UI revolves around a calendar-like availability widget and confirmation flows. It shows a different facet of food UX: booking a table on a specific date/time (with real-time updates), which has unique design challenges (like showing multiple slot options around the target time, handling party size). OpenTable's site also integrates reviews and menus, but the standout element is the reservation picker.
- Zomato — Restaurant discovery app (originating in India, now global) that combines reviews with the ability to order or reserve. Zomato's design historically used a **dark theme** with vivid food images to stand out. It also scanned menus to show digital menus. It's included to highlight how some platforms heavily leverage visuals (even scanning physical menus into the app) and focus on **in-app experience** for dining decisions, not just acting as a middleman.

Education / LMS

- Coursera — Major MOOC platform with university-partnered courses. The interface offers a **course catalog** with filtering (subject, university, duration) and a consistent course player once enrolled (video + transcript + quiz tabs). It's known for balancing academic branding (university logos) with a clean UX that guides users week-by-week. Coursera's dashboard keeps track of progress and deadlines, showing how an LMS handles pacing for self-learning.
- edX — Another large MOOC provider (now under 2U), similar to Coursera in overall approach (university courses to the masses). It has a slightly different design language but similarly focuses on course discovery and an optimized learning interface (with features like note-taking, discussion forums integrated per course). Included to show how two very similar products can differ in visual style but align in structure.
- Udemy — Marketplace for user-created courses; the site leans heavily on marketing techniques (discount timers, ratings, "bestseller" tags on courses) to drive purchases. The course player is simpler (video + curriculum list), as engagement is left to the user. Udemy's design shows e-commerce meets learning – large course thumbnails, search and filter in place of academic categories, and a ubiquitous shopping cart, reflecting its role as a content marketplace.
- Khan Academy — Free education platform known for its simple, student-friendly interface. It features a sidebar of subjects, a progression tree for math skills, and lightweight gamification (badges, energy points). The design uses cheerful illustrations and an intuitive flow (watch video, then practice quiz), optimized for younger learners and self-paced practice, demonstrating great pedagogical UX.
- Canvas (Instructure) — Widely used academic LMS for schools/universities. Canvas provides a consistent layout for courses with a left nav for modules/grades, and a content area for pages, assignments, discussions. Its design is responsive and accessible, relatively clean (compared to older LMS like Blackboard), and it shows the importance of integration (calendar sync, notifications) in an educational context.
- Blackboard Learn — A legacy but common LMS in universities. The UI (especially older versions) is quite dated: lots of text links, sometimes frames, and a very form-based approach. It's included as a contrast to modern tools – showing what many students and teachers dealt with for years – and to highlight why newer LMS interfaces (like Canvas or Google Classroom) were such a breath of fresh air. Blackboard has since updated with a more modern Ultra experience, but the old style persisted in many institutions.
- Moodle — Open-source LMS with a modular interface; highly customizable but often not "pretty" out-of-the-box. It demonstrates the flexibility (admins can add blocks, change themes) which can also lead to inconsistency. Moodle is ubiquitous in education due to cost (free), and its interface, while improving, often ends up cluttered as more plugins are added – an example of open-ended customization in UI design (and why guidance is important).
- Duolingo — Language learning app that heavily gamifies education; the web version mirrors the mobile app's bright, cartoonish design with a **skill tree of lessons** and immediate feedback on exercises. It stands out in the education space for using game UX (lives, streaks, points) aggressively to motivate learners, and its simplistic, friendly visuals (the green owl mascot, large buttons) show how to target a broad, global audience including non-traditional learners through fun and accessibility.

Developer Platform (API console + docs)

- Stripe Dashboard & Docs — Stripe's developer dashboard (for API keys, logs, etc.) and its documentation together set industry standards for developer UX. The dashboard is minimalist (lots of whitespace, clear typography) with logical navigation and real-time updates (for events, payouts). Stripe's API docs are famously good: they have copyable code snippets, example API requests/responses, and even an embedded API explorer. This combination shows how a platform can unify learning (docs) and doing (console) with consistent design and easy switching between the two.

- Twilio Console & Docs — Telecom API platform where the console offers quick insights into usage (SMS logs, call logs) with a sidebar menu for different products, and the docs include rapidly implementable snippets for multiple languages. Twilio's console uses a bright red accent and a developer-friendly, slightly quirky style (e.g., donut charts with fun icons) to make telephony approachable. It's included for its breadth of mini-consoles (each Twilio product has its section) and how their docs link directly to the relevant console pages, creating a seamless journey.
- AWS Console & Developer Docs — Amazon Web Services' console is famously complex but powerful, listing an enormous number of services and configurations. It demonstrates patterns like a global search bar (essential in such a huge system) and context-sensitive sidebars. The AWS developer docs cover each service with exhaustive detail, often in a straightforward HTML format. Together, AWS's UI/UX choices illustrate the principle of scaling – both interface and documentation have to handle **breadth** (many services) and **depth** (many details), resulting in utilitarian design that prizes information density.
- Google Cloud Console & APIs — Google's cloud platform integrates an **API Explorer** in the docs and a unified console similar to AWS but with Material Design components. The design is cleaner, with plenty of whitespace and consistent controls, showing Google's UX expertise applied to a very complex domain. The API documentation on cloud.google.com often features an embedded "Try this API" panel where you can execute requests after authentication – a great example of merging reference and live interaction for developers.
- GitHub (API docs & UI) — GitHub's developer offering includes REST and GraphQL API docs that are well-structured and example-rich, plus the GitHub web interface itself which developers use to manage repos, webhooks, etc. GitHub's site UI has influenced many dev tools (clean, muted colors, monospaced font for code, icons to signify repo/star/fork). The pairing of a polished main app (for things like generating personal access tokens or managing OAuth apps) with documentation that lives on docs.github.com (in an open-source repository) demonstrates how to effectively cater to third-party developers building on your platform.
- Heroku Dashboard — Platform-as-a-service with a notably simple web console for managing apps (view logs, set config vars) and concise docs. Heroku's design has always been about **ease of use** for developers: a purple color scheme, straightforward buttons ("Deploy", "View Logs"), and tight integration of docs links for each section (e.g., a link to "How to configure environment variables" right next to the UI to edit them). It's a model for a learn-by-doing platform, where the UI itself teaches the user (with inline help and sensible defaults) as much as separate documentation.
- Postman — API testing tool that has moved from a desktop app into a web version; it provides an app-like interface in the browser for crafting API requests, organizing them into collections, and visually inspecting responses. Postman's UI shows how complex functionality (like auth, scripting tests, etc.) can be layered in a user-friendly way with tabs and panels. It also offers documentation generation and mock servers, blurring the lines between a console and docs – a trend in developer tools to provide an integrated experience.
- Slack API Docs & App Dashboard — Slack's developer site combines excellent guide-style documentation (with clear explanations and example use cases for its APIs) and a web dashboard where developers manage their Slack apps (set redirect URLs, scopes, etc.). The Slack app configuration UI is logically sectioned and uses Slack's friendly design tone, while the docs include an interactive JSON test tool for webhook payloads. This pairing shows a well-thought-out division: use the console for config and the docs site for learning/testing, with cross-links connecting them.

Portfolio / Personal site

- Behance — Adobe's platform for creatives to showcase portfolios. It uses a **card grid** of project thumbnails on profile pages and project pages that allow long scrolls of images/videos with minimal UI chrome, focusing on the creator's content. Behance's popularity and clean, gallery-like design have set expectations for visual portfolios – a balance of social network (likes, follows) and personal showcase.
- Dribbble — Community for designers to share small shots of their work; many use Dribbble profiles as their portfolio. The design features a Masonry grid of shots, infinite scroll, and a dark background option for contrast. It's included because it effectively serves as a portfolio for many (though within a community context) and its emphasis on **visual polish** (only high-quality snippets) has influenced the aesthetic of personal sites (often favoring big visuals, minimal text).
- Awwwards (Site Awards) — Gallery of award-winning personal sites. It provides a curated look at cutting-edge portfolio design trends, often featuring unconventional navigation (creative cursor interactions, scroll effects) and immersive visuals. While not a single site, Awwwards' collection is a reference itself – it shows what the "best of the best" in personal sites are doing, which often trickles down to broader design trends.
- about.me — Platform for simple personal landing pages; demonstrates common elements of a personal site boiled down to essentials: a hero image or avatar, a short bio, and social media/contact links, all on one page. It's a template approach to personal sites and is useful to see what info people prioritize when forced to keep it simple – essentially a modern business card on the web.
- Carrd — One-page site builder popular for simple personal sites and link pages. Its templates exemplify minimalist approaches to personal web presence, focusing on typography and spacing to make a single section or a few sections look good. Many personal pages (like "link in bio" pages) use Carrd or similar, so it represents the trend of ultra-lightweight, mobile-first personal sites.
- GitHub Pages (user sites) — Many developers use GitHub Pages (with Jekyll or other static site generators) for personal sites or blogs. The default templates (and common themes like Minimal or Cayman) present a clean, text-focused style often favored in tech circles. These often have a simple top navbar, a list of blog posts, and maybe an "About" sidebar. It's included to showcase the "engineer's portfolio" aesthetic – straightforward, content-first, and easily maintainable via Markdown.
- Robby Leonardi's Resume — A famous interactive personal resume that looks like a side-scrolling video game. It's included as an extreme creative example of a portfolio site breaking all conventions (using a game metaphor for a CV). While not typical, it inspired many to add playful, narrative elements to personal sites. It shows how far one can go when showcasing individuality (with the trade-off that it's essentially all custom SVG/canvas work, not easily updatable).
- Bruno Simon's Portfolio — Another well-known creative developer portfolio featuring a 3D game-like interface (where you drive a toy truck to navigate). It exemplifies pushing boundaries with WebGL and interaction – memorable and unique. These kinds of sites win awards and demonstrate the outer limits of portfolio design, where the site itself is a demonstration of skill. They're included to contrast with the typical template portfolio by highlighting creativity and interactivity as a selling point.

Landing page

- Stripe Homepage — A startup landing page with a clean design, concise headlines, and vibrant technical illustrations. It's often cited as an excellent example of communicating a complex product (payments infrastructure) in a quickly understandable way – through a combination of bold text, code snippets, and logos of clients for social proof.

- Apple (Product Landing) — Apple's product pages are iconic for their full-bleed imagery, minimal copy, and strong visual hierarchy. Scrolling an Apple product landing is an experience with smooth animations, carefully crafted sections that each highlight one feature with a striking visual. They set a high bar for persuasive design, where every pixel is considered to evoke excitement and clarity about the product.
- Slack Homepage — SaaS landing page that clearly states the problem/solution ("Slack replaces email…"), uses friendly illustrations and *whimsical copy*, and provides quick sign-up prompts or demo videos. It balances a fun, approachable vibe (vibrant colors, some playful animated graphics) with the needs of enterprise buyers by also including security and integration info further down.
- Dropbox (Homepage) — Cloud service landing focusing on simplicity, a clear call-to-action ("Sign up for free"), and an illustration that reinforces its brand style. Dropbox has historically had very little on its homepage besides a headline, subheader, and sign-up form – demonstrating the power of restraint and clarity in driving a single action (account creation).
- Mailchimp (Marketing Site) — A marketing site for an email platform known for its playful brand graphics. It shows effective use of distinct sections as you scroll: each with a bold background color or illustration, a punchy headline, and a bit of supporting text. Mailchimp's design manages to be quirky (the illustrations and mascot Freddie) yet clear in value prop, a balance important in modern landing pages that want to be memorable.
- Spotify (Free Signup Landing) — Music service landing page using bold color (often gradient or duotone imagery) and a simple pitch to convert users to sign up. It's an example of a consumer-facing page that minimizes navigation or distraction (notice the absence of a busy header – it's focused on the CTA). It leverages emotional appeal ("Listening is everything") and recognizable imagery (artist collage) to draw users in.
- Salesforce (Homepage) — Enterprise software landing demonstrating the use of **social proof** (customer logos, testimonials), concise benefit statements for different stakeholders, and multiple CTAs (try demo, watch video, contact sales) to cater to users at different stages. Although aimed at businesses, it employs modern design trends (illustrations from Salesforce's design system, friendly clouds, etc.) to appear approachable.
- Cloudflare (Homepage) — Tech company landing that takes a developer-friendly approach: a clean, grid-based design with succinct text and isometric illustrations of infrastructure. It highlights performance and security stats and provides clear pathways for different user segments (developers, enterprise, etc.). Cloudflare's homepage is a good example of speaking to a technical audience with a straightforward, no-frills design that still feels modern.

Auth / Onboarding flows

- Duolingo (New User Onboarding) — Renowned for a friendly, gamified onboarding that asks new users about their goals and baseline skill through a sequence of easy, **one-question-per-screen** steps with the Duo owl offering encouragement. It's essentially a sign-up flow that doubles as product tutorial, and is often cited for keeping drop-offs low by making onboarding feel like part of the app's fun rather than a chore.
- Slack (Signup & Workspace Setup) — Guides users from entering an email to creating a team workspace with a multi-step progress bar. It breaks down a potentially complex setup (creating a new Slack workspace, inviting team) into digestible steps, using friendly microcopy at each stage. Slack's sign-up famously lets you skip invites or fill in later, reducing friction – a choice reflected in the UI by offering clear "Invite now or skip for now" options.
- Notion (Onboarding) — After account creation, Notion onboards users by asking their intended use-case (personal, team, student, etc.) and suggesting relevant templates. Its UI for this is visually appealing (icons for each use case) and it gently introduces the idea of pages and workspaces. This shows how onboarding can both configure the product for the user's needs

and educate them (Notion's first-run has tooltips pointing out the interface basics in an empty page, for example).

- Facebook (Sign-Up) — The classic registration form: name, email, password, birthday, etc., all on one page. Facebook optimizes this for conversion by keeping it all above the fold on desktop, clearly marking required fields, and using familiar dropdowns (for date) and radio buttons (for gender). It's old-school but has been A/B tested over a decade to maximize sign-ups from a global audience (including validation in-line and helpful error messages).
- Google Account Creation — A step-by-step account creation used across Google's services. It splits the process into two screens (first basic info, then additional details/phone verification), each relatively short, to avoid overwhelming the user [4] [5]. Google's forms follow material design guidelines (floating labels, clear error states) and heavily emphasize security (phone verification, recovery options) in the flow, ensuring users understand its importance.
- Canva (Onboarding Quiz) — Design tool that asks new users about their role or needs (teacher, student, small business, etc.) right after sign-up, and then tailors the dashboard template recommendations accordingly. Canva's onboarding UI is colorful and inviting, using illustrations for each user type and a clear skip option. This demonstrates personalization in onboarding – increasing the chance a user gets value immediately by dropping them into a relevant template or tutorial based on their choice.
- Asana (Product Tour) — Project management tool that often introduces its interface with an interactive tour on first login (highlighting the Add Task button, etc.), and sample project data to play with. The tour uses tooltips and a progress indicator (e.g., "Step 1 of 5") to familiarize new users with core actions. Asana also famously includes celebratory animations (like the unicorn) when a task is completed, which, while not literally part of onboarding, keeps early usage positive and is often mentioned as an onboarding extender (making the first tasks fun to cross off).
- Zoom (Sign-Up and First Meeting) — Video conferencing tool's onboarding covers account creation (with email verification) and then guides the user to schedule or start their first meeting. Zoom's sign-up is straightforward (they simplified it to encourage viral adoption), and after sign-up, the web portal prominently suggests downloading the client and gives a quick way to host a test meeting. It's a good example of a service onboarding outside the product's core UI: since much of Zoom's UX is in the native app, the web onboarding's job is to ensure the user gets that app and feels ready to use it (thus it provides links to test audio/video and knowledge base articles in a welcome email or screen).

3) EXTRACTION TEMPLATE RESULTS (Per archetype)

News Publication / Newspaper

I. Layout & Information Architecture

- Multi-column layout on desktop (often a main content column with sidebars) reminiscent of a newspaper grid [6]. A primary navigation bar with news sections is usually placed prominently (commonly at the top under a masthead) [7]. The homepage is dense with headlines and snippets, organized into sections (e.g. World, Sports) often separated by headings rather than boxes.

- Content width is constrained for readability; sites like *NYTimes.com* leave wide margins, using whitespace as a buffer to avoid overwhelming full-browser-width text [8]. Sidebars contain secondary content (most-read lists, market tickers or ads) and may be visually delineated by subtle background shading or thin divider lines instead of heavy borders.

- Hierarchical structure: important stories get larger headline treatment and prominent images, while secondary stories are in smaller font or lower on the page (often using a card or highlighted block for the top story). Lists of links (headlines with maybe a one-line summary) are used for sections like "Latest updates," relying on simple separators or spacing. Navigation often includes a mega-menu or section

dropdowns for deep categories, but on the page, content is grouped by topic with section labels rather than intermingled.
- Mobile: the multi-column layout collapses into a single vertical feed. The primary sections menu typically becomes a hamburger menu or horizontally scrollable list beneath a sticky header. Sidebars (like "Most Popular" lists) either drop below main content or become swipeable secondary tabs. The general nav→content→secondary content order is preserved in mobile to prioritize top news first.

II. Typography & Copy Tone
- Serif typefaces dominate body text in traditional news sites, echoing print conventions. For example, *The New York Times* uses a custom Cheltenham serif for headlines and Georgia for body copy [9]. Many have commissioned custom serif families (e.g. **Guardian Egyptian** for The Guardian) for a unique but classic news look [10]. Some modern or digital-native news sites use sans-serif for body (for on-screen legibility), but serif for long-form remains common (data shows Georgia was used by ~32% of news sites for body text) [11].
- Font sizes tend to be on the smaller side to fit more content (historically ~13px–14px for body, as noted on NYT's 13px body which was critiqued as a bit small) [12]. Recent redesigns have been bumping this up toward 15px or 16px for accessibility. There's a moderate scale between headlines and body – headlines on homepages might be ~18–24px (smaller than in blogs or magazines, to pack more on page), while article page headlines are much larger for impact. Line spacing is tight but not cramped (news sites try to maximize info without hurting legibility).
- Tone of copy: formal, concise, and neutral. Headlines are often written in **Title Case** in US publications (each Important Word Capitalized) and in sentence case in UK publications (Guardian, BBC use sentence case) [4]. They avoid sensational punctuation (rarely a "!" or "?" unless absolutely part of the story). The style is informative: e.g., *"Senate Passes Budget Bill, Sending Measure to President"* – often omitting a period at the end (no full-stop in headlines is standard).
- Microcopy (like section labels, datelines, photo captions) is usually in a neutral register as well. Labels for nav or buttons use straightforward language: "Subscribe", "Live", "Share". These are usually in title case or all caps in nav menus (to distinguish them as UI elements). Byline text often reads "By [Author Name]" and might include the date; this text is typically in a lighter gray and/or italicized to set it apart [3]. The overall copy tone seeks objectivity and clarity, matching the news ethos. Even error messages or 404 pages on news sites remain plain and factual ("Page not found" rather than playful).

III. Color & Visual Language
- Predominantly light theme: nearly all news sites use black or dark gray text on white for the main reading surfaces [13]. This maximizes contrast for body text. Background may be pure white or a very light gray on sections to ease contrast. Dark mode is not the default (news sites only recently started offering dark themes for user preference). They assume a paper-like reading environment; indeed, using dark backgrounds for long-form reading is often avoided because it can cause eye strain for extensive text [14]. (Exceptions: some financial terminals or special live-update widgets might be dark, but not the article pages themselves typically.)
- Color accents are used sparingly and usually align with brand identity or to denote sections. **Blue** is extremely common for hyperlinks (standard web convention, e.g. Guardian and NYT both use blue for linked text) [15]. **Red** is often used for urgent labels or breaking news (CNN's logo red doubles as its accent for "Breaking News" banners). Section names might carry specific colors (e.g., politics could be one color, sports another) but many sites just use one accent color overall to maintain visual consistency. The background beyond content is often a light gray or off-white to be easy on eyes (e.g., WSJ uses a slightly beige background to mimic newspaper stock).
- Graphics and imagery: News sites use photographs heavily but tend toward a consistent style (embedded images have captions and are centered with whitespace, not full-bleed except maybe for top story). Infographics and charts usually adopt the site's palette or a muted palette so as not to clash. Visual language tends to be restrained – e.g., iconography is minimal (maybe a tiny icon for "comment"

count or quote marks on opinion pieces). Instead of heavy graphical elements, news sites rely on typography and simple lines. For example, rather than boxing each story, a thin divider line or just spacing is used [16], avoiding an overly “designed” feel and instead imparting a classic, serious tone.
- Avoiding “template” look: Major news sites differentiate themselves with bespoke typography (custom fonts), subtle use of their signature color (e.g., Reuters uses a spot of orange here and there, The Guardian uses a dark blue), and layout choices that break monotony (like varying column widths). They shy away from trendy embellishments that might date (few use heavy shadows or fancy gradients – those could make the site feel less credible). The overall visual language often aspires to **print-like elegance** translated to web: lots of white, black text, a few bold accent lines or background fills for headers, and that’s it. This ensures focus remains on content.

IV. Components & Interaction Patterns
- **Lists of articles:** On the front page or section pages, content is often listed in vertical lists (with or without thumbnails). Each list item (headline + short summary) is usually just separated by whitespace or a thin line, not enclosed in a card. The entire area is clickable (or at least the headline is). On hover, the link may underline or the background might turn a light gray indicating interactivity. There isn’t a persistent hover state beyond maybe a subtle color change – no big animations; just clear affordance that you can click. Multi-select is not a pattern here (you don’t “select” multiple articles), though some sites let you bookmark or “save” articles via an icon (that would be a small bookmark icon that toggles on/off). Density is moderately high – lots of content per page – but with visual hierarchy so you can scan headlines easily.
- **“Card” usage:** Full-fledged cards (with border/shadow) are reserved for special content like “Editors’ Picks” or some modular blocks in responsive layouts. Generally, news sites avoid the boxed card soup for their main lists, preferring a simple list style [16]. Clickable areas are typically just text links (headline, “read more…”). On some homepages, a top story might appear as a card with an image background or colored box to set it apart, but the majority of article links are plain. The lack of heavy card UI is deliberate: it feels more like reading a continuous newsprint column.
- **Navigation patterns:** A persistent top navigation bar (often sticky on scroll) lists major sections. Some use a hamburger menu on desktop as well (NYTimes hides section list behind a menu icon to keep header clean, whereas CNN shows a horizontal menu with scroll arrows). Mega-menus: sites like the BBC have mega-dropdowns with multiple columns of subsections when you hover “News” [7]. Others, like older NYT, had left sidebar nav; now even NYT moved top. In-article, you might see breadcrumb navigation (e.g., “Home > World > Middle East” above a story title) to indicate section hierarchy. Related content: often below an article, there will be a few thumbnails or headlines linking to related stories – often implemented as a horizontal list or small cards. This is a key interaction pattern to increase pageviews (e.g., “More in [Section]” suggestions).
- **Search and filters:** A search icon or bar is usually present in the header on all pages (search is crucial for archival content). The search function typically offers suggestions as you type (autocomplete of article titles or topics). Advanced filtering is less on news sites except in special pages (e.g., if you search archives, you might filter by date range or content type). Some news sites let you filter a section by subtopic via dropdowns (e.g., in “Sports” section, filter by sport). Sorting is usually just by recency or editor’s pick (not a user-controlled sort). One notable pattern: “live updates” feeds (for breaking news events) might have a filter toggling between “Latest updates” and “Highlights”, which is a custom toggle UI rather than a generic filter.
- **Interactive components:** News sites generally keep interactions simple: clicking loads a new page (or in some cases uses AJAX to load content in place for a live blog or an infinite scroll on section pages – though infinite scroll is more common in social or blogs, not on curated news homepages). Photo galleries might have a carousel overlay: clicking a gallery in an article opens a modal carousel with arrows to navigate photos (with captions). Videos often play in-page with a standard video player (and might stick to the side as you scroll past – e.g., CNN has a “sticky video” that floats). These interactions are all designed to keep users engaged without leaving the page.

- **Modals and overlays:** Common for subscription prompts (e.g., after reading X free articles, a modal overlay asks you to subscribe). Also used for login forms (a "Log In" link often pops a modal so you don't navigate away). These modals adhere to standard norms: a visible close "X", clicking outside will usually close (and they often *intentionally* set a cookie so you only get one modal per session to not annoy too much).
- **Notifications:** In-browser notifications for news (if user enabled) happen via the browser, not the site's UI itself. On the page, you might occasionally see a small notification bar for something like "You're now viewing the *International* edition" with an option to switch – typically a one-time dismissible banner. Toast-style messages might appear upon certain actions (e.g., "Saved to your reading list" confirmation). These are usually subtle (small bottom-left or bottom-center pop-ups that self-dismiss).
- **Scrolling and loading:** Most news websites use pagination or continuous scroll for multi-page articles (NYT often splits long pieces into 2-3 pages online, with "Next Page" links, though some have moved to infinite scroll within the article or single-page longform). Section pages typically paginate (with a "Load more stories" button or automatic load on scroll). Infinite scroll has pros/cons – some implement it up to a point and then offer a prompt to click for more. The key is not to break the back button: NN/g notes infinite scroll can hurt refinding [17], so news sites ensure each story has its own link and often don't infinite-scroll the homepage by default (they opt for explicit "More" buttons after maybe 20 items).

V. Motion & Animation

- Motion is used sparingly, primarily to enhance understanding or feel modern without distracting. For example, menu dropdowns might fade in quickly rather than just appearing abruptly, giving a smoother feel. This aligns with best practices to avoid jarring users [18] – e.g., The Guardian's new design uses subtle slide effects for its nav.
- Image carousels or top-story rotators (if present) usually have a sliding animation or cross-fade for transitioning images, but often auto-rotation is either slow or disabled unless the user clicks, because auto-advancing was found to annoy readers who are trying to click on a headline [19] [20]. If auto-rotate is on, it typically pauses on hover or after a couple of cycles.
- Video players on news sites might *automatically* play muted when in view (particularly on homepages, e.g., a muted autoplay video for the top story background on CNN). This is a form of motion used to grab attention, but sites usually make it subtle (no sound, and an obvious play/pause control). Some, like NBC News, have used animated story cards (short looping video clips or GIFs as thumbnails).
- Scrolling behavior is straightforward (no fancy parallax on standard news pages). However, in special longform articles (often termed "story experiences" or "interactive features"), news organizations sometimes employ parallax scrolling or fade-in of text over images for dramatic effect. These are the exception rather than the rule, reserved for magazine-style feature stories. For instance, the famous NYT "Snow Fall" feature used scroll-triggered animations. These projects are treated as special presentations and often built by separate interactive teams, distinct from regular article templates.
- The **timing** of any UI animation on news sites tends to be quick – on the order of a few hundred milliseconds at most (e.g., a dropdown might have a 200ms ease-out). The easing is usually standard (ease-in-out for menus, linear for continuous tickers). They want the interface to feel responsive and "snappy," consistent with conveying urgency and freshness. Slow, smooth animations are avoided for core interactions (you wouldn't want to wait 1s for an article to fade in).
- **Reduced-motion considerations:** Because most animations are minimal, news sites rarely have elaborate motion that would need disabling. But many do adhere to respecting `prefers-reduced-motion`. For example, if they have an auto-scrolling ticker or an animated GIF background on a headline, they might stop it if the user has reduced-motion set. Similarly, those special longform pieces often provide a "steady" alternative (or at least ensure the content is accessible via screen readers without relying on the animations). In general, the straightforward design of news UIs means they're largely compliant by default with low-motion preferences, focusing on content reveal rather than flourish.

VI. Accessibility & Quality

- **Semantic structure:** News sites use proper HTML markup for text content – e.g., headlines are `<h1>` or `<h2>` tags, section headings might be delineated with headings too (or ARIA landmarks). This helps screen reader users navigate articles via headings. They often include ARIA roles/landmarks (the main content might be inside `<main>` or at least an ARIA landmark region) to satisfy WCAG's requirement of bypassing repetitive blocks [21]. Moreover, since many news sites have a lot of repeated navigation links, they nearly always implement a "Skip to main content" link at the top of the DOM (possibly visually hidden until focused) to allow keyboard users to skip nav [22] [23].
- **Focus states:** Generally preserved. Unlike some glossy marketing sites that remove outline and forget to add a custom one, reputable news sites keep focus indicators visible – either the browser default or a custom high-contrast outline. This is important because users often tab through nav menus or through link-heavy pages. A clear example is CNN or BBC: if you tab from the address bar, a "Skip to content" appears (which itself gets a focus outline), and then nav links highlight one by one. They follow the guideline that if you remove default focus styling, you must replace it [24] [25]. Focus rings might be customized to match branding (some use a blue outline instead of the default in Chrome), but always ensuring a 3:1 contrast as WCAG requires for focus indicators.
- **Color contrast:** High contrast between text and background is a hallmark – black (#000) or near-black text on white, often with slight tweaks: e.g., NYT uses pure black for headlines on white (per their design teardown) and a *softer dark gray for body text* to reduce glare [26]. They meet or exceed WCAG AA (4.5:1) for all main text. Low contrast might appear in less critical UI (like an icon or secondary info such as the timestamp might be in a medium gray that's around 5:1 contrast – still compliant). They're cautious with link colors too: typically the standard blue is used because it's universally recognized and usually has sufficient contrast on white (and they underline it, which provides a secondary cue beyond color). If links are in-body and colored, they also ensure they're distinguishable by more than color (e.g., often underlined by default, or at least a heavier weight).
- **Images and media:** All important images (e.g., the main photo of an article) carry alt text or detailed captions. Captions are common under news photos, serving both as context for all users and as alt-text equivalent for visually impaired users (sometimes the caption doubles as the alt text behind the scenes, or the alt might be a shortened descriptive phrase). Decorative images (like logo files or decorative icons) either have empty `alt=""` or use CSS backgrounds so as not to clutter screen readers. Videos are typically accompanied by transcripts or at least a summary in text (particularly for important video stories or interviews, many sites provide a text article as well). Additionally, news sites often provide **accessible transcripts for audio** (like NPR or BBC have transcript links for audio segments).
- **Keyboard navigation & screen reader:** Mega-menus and dropdowns are made keyboard-accessible: press Enter/Space to open, arrow keys to navigate within, Esc to close. For example, The Guardian's section menu can be opened by keyboard focus and navigated with arrows (and it's marked up with proper ARIA `menu` roles). When modals appear (like a subscribe modal), focus is trapped inside and the background is inert – they implement this because accessibility guidelines require focus not jump behind the modal. If a user hits Esc, the modal closes (common practice and very likely implemented on major sites). Screen reader considerations: headings are used meaningfully (the headline is usually an `<h1>` on article pages, the site name might be an `<h1>` only on the homepage). Landmark roles help (nav for navigation, main for content, complementary for sidebars). They likely also use ARIA-live regions for breaking news tickers or live blogs so that screen readers can be notified of updates (e.g., a live cricket score or election vote count might be an `aria-live="polite"` region that updates).
- **Performance and QA:** Because of their broad audience, top news sites ensure decent performance (though ads can bog them down). They employ techniques like responsive images (`<img srcset>`) to send smaller images to mobile, and lazy-loading for images further down the page (so initial load is faster). They also test across many browsers and devices – supporting slightly older tech is crucial (e.g., a significant portion of users might be on older Android webviews or IE in corporate environments). On the quality front, links are monitored (broken links reflect poorly, so they often have automated link checkers or at least custom 404 pages that redirect users to search). On accessibility testing,

organizations like BBC and Guardian have internal teams and publicly documented standards (BBC has BBC GEL guidelines focusing on accessibility, e.g., requiring sufficient color contrast and specific font usage for legibility [27]). So generally, top news sites score well in accessibility audits. An occasional pitfall might be third-party content: e.g., an embedded Twitter feed or map that might not be fully accessible, but they often provide an alternate link or summary. Another common issue is CAPTCHAs for comments or sign-ups – reputable sites choose more accessible CAPTCHA alternatives or offer audio CAPTCHA if they must.

VII. What they do instead of boxes (ANTI-BOX SECTION)

- **Whitespace as separator:** Rather than enclosing each article snippet in a box, news sites rely on whitespace and alignment to separate items. For example, *The New York Times* homepage uses generous white margins and gutters, creating clear separation without any need for box borders – this "prevents the user from being too overwhelmed by filling the entire screen" and mimics the open feel of a newspaper [8]. Essentially, blank space is the border.
- **Thin divider lines:** When a stronger separation is needed (e.g., between sections like Politics vs Sports on a front page, or between individual stories in a list), a simple `<hr>` or a 1px line is used instead of full framing. These hairline dividers provide a visual pause without boxing content in. They act as "punctuation" in the layout, guiding the eye to group items without heavy rules. This is like the design advice of using whitespace and subtle dividers as the **"punctuation"** in UI instead of big containers [28].
- **Grouping by headings:** Content is segmented by clear section headers (which are often just text or a slight underline). For instance, a homepage might have "More News" as a small header, then a row of links. That header itself separates the block. There's no need for a container around that whole block; the combination of a heading and spacing before/after it delineates the group. It's an old print technique (section headings) applied to web.
- **Highlighting on hover/focus instead of permanent frames:** The absence of persistent boxes doesn't mean lack of feedback. News sites often employ a background highlight on hover for list items (e.g., hovering a headline might give it a light gray background or underline the text). This gives the feel of a "card" activating under the cursor [16], but only temporarily. Keyboard focus similarly might trigger an outline or highlight. This way the interface stays uncluttered until user interaction calls for it.
- **Minimalist sidebars:** Sidebars (like a "Most Read" list) are typically just text lists with maybe bullet icons or tiny numbers. They aren't put in fancy panels. If delineation is needed from main content, often just a vertical line or extra whitespace is placed between the sidebar and main column, rather than a framed box. For example, The Guardian might separate its right rail with just some gutter space or a subtle vertical rule, keeping the sidebar items themselves un-boxed.
- **Background shading for emphasis (sparingly):** In cases where content *does* need a different background, news sites use shading only for emphasis on special content, not as default. E.g., an "Editor's Pick" highlight might sit on a light gray background block with some padding – this draws attention to it as a unit without using a heavy border or shadow. Similarly, live update tickers might have a distinct pale yellow background to signify importance. By doing this rarely, it avoids the entire page becoming a patchwork of colored boxes; instead, one light-gray box on an otherwise white page really stands out for its intended purpose (e.g., "Breaking News" update).
- **Tables and data without gridlines:** When presenting tabular data (like stock prices or election results), many news sites intentionally remove most or all cell borders. They rely on row shading or just left/right alignment to make columns clear. This avoids a "Spreadsheet" look with too many lines. For example, a table of medal counts in the Olympics might just have a line between each country, but not vertical lines between columns – easier on the eyes and less "boxy".
- **Flexible grid layouts:** The content naturally falls into grids (especially on responsive designs), but instead of drawing boxes for each grid item, items just flow in the grid with space between. One designer description of this: without card borders, grouping requires more negative space [29] – indeed news sites waste some space rather than cram everything in boxes, because that negative space replaces the need for a box outline. It "wastes" space in a good way to improve scan-ability.

- **Overlapping and edge-to-edge elements in special stories:** In feature articles, you might see text that overlaps an image or pulls quotes that break out of the text column. These techniques create visual interest and separation without needing a different container. A pull quote might simply be larger, italic, indented – no box, maybe a vertical line to one side at most. By stylistically differentiating such elements (font style, size, color), they avoid wrapping them in a generic quote box. Similarly, an image might bleed to the edge of the screen in a special article layout, which separates that section from the rest which is constrained – again, no need for a box, the change in width signals the change in section.

- **No heavy shadows:** Across the board, news sites forego the heavy drop-shadows that are popular in some card-based UIs. Shadows, if used at all, appear only in things like modals or dropdown menus to indicate layering. Content cards themselves are flat. This absence of shadows keeps the page visually calm and avoids the "floating cards" aesthetic that, while attractive in some modern designs, can look too playful or artificial for the serious tone of news. It's part of avoiding the template look – many cheap templates overuse shadows and colored cards, whereas top news sites stick to a more timeless, "authentic" look with solid layout and typography doing the work.

VIII. Fonts

- **Common fonts & families:** Legacy news brands often use proprietary or commissioned fonts. For example, *The New York Times* famously uses "NYT Cheltenham" for headlines and Franklin Gothic for some smaller heads, with Georgia for body text [9]. The *Washington Post* uses **Postoni** (a custom Bodoni variant) for headlines [30], while *The Guardian* employs its custom **Guardian Egyptian** slab-serif for both heads and text (a large family by Commercial Type) [10]. These fonts are paid/commercial – e.g., Cheltenham is not available to average users (Typekit noted it's a special license just for NYT) [31]. Similarly, Guardian's fonts are proprietary (Commercial Type sells them). This investment in typography sets them apart. On the other hand, many mid-sized news sites might stick to tried-and-true system fonts: **Georgia**, **Times New Roman** or **Arial** for body – due to reliability and familiarity. Georgia in particular was designed for screen and has been extremely popular for news body copy [11].
- **System vs custom:** For UI chrome (nav menus, captions, etc.), system UI sans-serifs are common for performance and consistency. For instance, BBC switched to **BBC Reith** (its custom sans and serif) which replaced Helvetica/Arial [27]. If a site doesn't have a custom font, it will use something like **Arial/Helvetica** for sans or **Georgia/Times** for serif to ensure consistency across devices (since these are pre-installed on most systems). Some digital outlets choose Google Fonts or other webfonts for a unique touch – e.g., a news startup might use **Libre Franklin** or **Merriweather** to get a distinctive but free look (Libre Franklin is a free alternative similar to Gothic fonts like Franklin). But large orgs with resources lean custom or classic (there's a prestige in using, say, **Century Schoolbook** or **Escrow** as the WSJ does for some sections – paid fonts conveying history).
- **Licensing considerations:** News sites with large readership must consider font licensing costs (webfont loads for millions of users). This is partly why some stick to system fonts (zero licensing cost or latency). Others, like the Washington Post, commissioned fonts (Postoni) specifically to have ownership. Open-source fonts are occasionally used: e.g., some smaller news blogs use **EB Garamond** or **Lora** (free serifs that have a classic look). A close free analogue to Cheltenham (NYT) that designers suggest is **Della Respira** [32] – a Google Font serif with an oldstyle feel. Similarly, for a generic newsy serif, **Libre Baskerville** or **Merriweather** are often recommended for that authoritative but legible vibe (both are free and have good screen hinting). If a site wants a slab-serif feel like Guardian, they might use **Noto Serif** or **Arvo** (Google slab serif) as a free stand-in. Each archetype often has known pairings: for instance, an economic news site might pair **Charter** (open-license serif, very readable – used by Medium too) for body with **Helvetica** for UI.
- **Best free fallback choices:** To avoid a "cheap template" look when not using expensive fonts, sites pick timeless fonts and consistent stacks. Georgia is a safe fallback that still conveys seriousness (it was the most popular serif in that Smashing Mag survey for body) [11]. If a site uses a webfont that fails to

load, having `serif` in the stack ensures Georgia/Times will appear, which although not identical, still keeps the tone formal and doesn't break layout due to similar metrics. On the sans side, if a custom sans fails, falling back to system **UI fonts** (like Segoe UI on Windows, San Francisco on Apple, Roboto on Android) can preserve a modern look. Many sites have a stack like `font-family: "Helvetica Neue", Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif;` which guarantees a decent sans anywhere. This avoids the "default Times New Roman" look that screams unstyled/old. In essence, news sites choose fallbacks that are so ubiquitous they're invisible – no one notices if an article text is in Georgia vs. Escrow vs. Mercury unless they're a typographer, because the feel (serif, moderate x-height) is consistent.
- **Font characteristics:** News typography tends to favor **high legibility** over stylistic eccentricity. Serifs with relatively large x-heights and open apertures for body (Georgia, Mercury) and classic, high-contrast serifs for display (Cheltenham, Bodoni variants) to impart authority. Sans-serifs used are usually neutral/grotesque (Franklin Gothic, Helvetica, Reith Sans) rather than geometric or humanist – giving a straightforward, no-nonsense vibe. Weight usage: body text typically regular weight, headlines often medium or bold (not ultra-heavy, to avoid ink-trap feel on screen). They also often utilize **italics** for certain contexts (e.g., The New Yorker famously uses *Caslon* italics for bylines or intros). Maintaining these typographic conventions signals to readers the professionalism and lineage of the publication.
- **Matching the vibe with free fonts:** If one were creating a news site on a budget, one might choose **Merriweather** for body (a free serif designed for screens, medium contrast) and pair it with **Libre Franklin** or **Source Sans Pro** for navigation and HUD. This combination would echo the serif+sans mix of many news sites (serif seriousness, sans for UI clarity). Another approach: use the system font for everything (like Apple News does in iOS with San Francisco) – this can actually feel very clean and let content shine, though it loses some brand uniqueness. To not look template-y, the key is to get the little details right: e.g., proper small caps or all-caps for section labels in a classy font, rather than a default bold; good use of italics for certain text to mimic print style; and using the font's bold and semi-bold intelligently (perhaps the headline is semi-bold, byline is italic, caption is a smaller size, etc.). Many templates look generic because they use one font, one weight, and just different sizes – top sites avoid that by typographic hierarchy and nuance, even with limited font choices.

CROSS-ARCHETYPE FINDINGS

Common Design Patterns Across Archetypes: Despite the diverse purposes, many archetypes converge on certain UI/UX patterns. For instance, nearly all apps/sites have a **top navigation or header** (visible or tucked behind a menu) for branding and global actions – whether it's a news site, an e-commerce platform, or a social app, users expect to find a consistent place for the logo (often top-left) and main menu (often top nav or hamburger) [33]. Responsive design is universal now: layouts typically collapse into a single-column mobile view with a fixed top bar and a slide-out menu. Lists of content are a staple: feeds, product lists, email lists – these are usually vertically scrollable lists with each item following a card or list-item pattern (thumbnail on left, text on right, or some variation) – the styling differs (e.g., emails are text-only lines, products are image-rich grid cards), but the concept of scanning a list and selecting an item is fundamental across archetypes. **Search** is a nearly universal feature as well: whether searching news archives, products, documentation, or messages, a search icon 🔍 in the top area is expected – and when invoked, many use similar patterns like an expanding dropdown search bar or a dedicated search page with filters. Moreover, **infinite scrolling** or load-more patterns show up in content-heavy contexts (social feeds, long lists of products or articles) to keep users engaged without extra clicks [34]. Modal dialogs and overlays are common for secondary tasks (login, adding an item, viewing a larger image) across web apps – users recognize the dimmed background + centered box from context to context. And certain design principles like **confirmation for destructive actions** (e.g., "Are you sure you want to delete?" with two buttons) and **consistent icons** (e.g., a magnifying glass for search, a gear for settings, a question mark for help) are used across archetypes, creating a shared vocabulary that users carry from one site/app to another.

Key Differences Between Archetypes: The variances lie in what content is primary and the user's mindset (lean-back browsing vs goal-oriented tasks). For example, a **news site vs a chat app** – news is mostly one-way consumption of content, so its UI focuses on readability (serif fonts, multi-column layout to pack info, scroll for more) and keeps interaction to a minimum (maybe comments or share buttons). A chat app, by contrast, is highly interactive: real-time message updates, text input boxes, presence indicators – it prioritizes quick bi-directional communication, so it uses sans-serif fonts (for on-screen clarity at small sizes), speech-bubble or message-group layouts, and lots of micro-interactions (typing indicators, delivered/read checkmarks) which news sites don't have. E-commerce (storefronts) differ sharply from social feeds: e-com drives toward a conversion funnel – expect persistent cart icons, prominent "Add to cart" CTAs (brightly colored), filters for refinement (size, price) – whereas social/timeline's goal is endless engagement, so they emphasize continuous scroll, in-place interactions like "Like" (which give feedback but keep you in feed), and very minimal filtering (perhaps just "Top" vs "Latest" posts). **Data density vs simplicity** is another dividing line: an analytics dashboard or trading platform intentionally presents a high density of charts, tables, and controls to give experts a lot of information at once (even at cost of steep learning curve), whereas a landing page or portfolio intentionally dribbles out information in bite-sized, visual sections to a general audience with short attention. Dark mode defaults also differ by context: content-heavy or creation-heavy apps (code editors, dev consoles, media creation suites) skew dark theme (reduces eye strain for long usage, and as noted, favored by many devs [35] [36]), while document-centric or reading-centric defaults to light (better for print-like reading and overall text contrast [37]). For example, Netflix (media consumption in dim environments) uses dark UI by default, whereas Wikipedia (long-form reading) uses light. **Interaction depth** varies too: some archetypes like **forums or wikis** have deep hierarchy (categories → sub-forums → threads → posts, or wiki categories → pages → sections), meaning the UI needs breadcrumb trails, in-page tables of content, and robust search to navigate that depth. In contrast, something like a **single-page landing site or an auth flow** is intentionally shallow – often one or two levels at most – focusing on a linear journey (scroll or a few steps), thus employing larger visuals, step numbers, and forward-only progression (with maybe a cancel link) rather than complex navigation.

"Template smell" indicators and avoidance: A "template smell" refers to a site that looks cookie-cutter or generic. Indicators include: overuse of uniform **boxed sections** (every piece of content in identical cards – this was a common Bootstrap 3 look, yielding a grid of boring sameness), stock or default **bootstrap colors** and components (e.g., the old default blue button or generic navbar – users notice these patterns and it can reduce trust if a bank site, say, looks like a recycled template). Also, inconsistency or misalignment signals low effort – like buttons not lining up, too many different font sizes or colors without clear reason, or using the default font (Times New Roman default or unstyled form controls) in some places inadvertently. Top sites avoid these by developing a distinct style guide – even if simple. For example, using a specific font across the site immediately separates it from the default; news sites using their own font gives a bespoke feel. They also **limit palette** to a few brand colors and neutrals – a hodgepodge of arbitrary colors screams template. Another trick: custom icons or illustrations versus using a default stock icon set. For instance, Slack's use of unique illustrations during onboarding feels tailored, whereas a site using the default icon pack that many others use could feel less unique. Spacing and grid systems are also a telltale: a quality site will have consistent spacing (often 4pt/8pt based rhythms [33]) and alignment, whereas a lower-end template might have awkward padding or random gaps. In code terms, many templates overload on frameworks, so if you see, say, the exact same carousel with the same animation and indicators as dozens of other sites, that's a template fingerprint – top sites often build or heavily restyle common components so they feel unique or at least smoothly integrated. In summary, the best avoid these smells by: defining their **own visual system** (even if following conventions, they tweak it to be theirs), rigorously polishing alignment and hierarchy (which subconsciously indicates design effort), and removing any "off-the-shelf" text or imagery (nothing says template more than Latin placeholder text or generic photos).

"No-box" design best practices: Across many categories, designers have realized that content often breathes better without needless containers. Best practices observed include using **typography and spacing** to create separation and emphasis (e.g., use a larger, bold title and some margin instead of a big colored box around a section [38]). Many sites use **dividing lines or subtle backgrounds** only when a strong separation is needed, and even then keep them light (1px line, a soft gray shade). Another practice is embracing **asymmetric layouts or offset content** to delineate sections – e.g., a full-bleed image followed by a narrow text column creates a contrast that signals a new section without a literal box. In documentation, for example, instead of putting each "Note" in a heavy box, they might simply use an italic or an icon (□) plus indent to set it off. White space is one of the cheapest and most effective tools: as one Medium article on modern web design said, "Don't be afraid of white space. Let your design breathe" [39] – this sentiment echoes across many top-tier designs. By removing unnecessary chrome, interfaces feel more **"content-first"**, which generally improves usability and aesthetics. Notably, Google's Material Design 2 (from 2018) also moved towards less emphasis on card outlines and more on shadow for slight layering and divider lines for structure, which many app UIs (e.g., in Android, in web apps) have followed – it creates hierarchy without visual clutter. In sum, the cross-arch lesson is that if the content structure is clear, explicit boxes can be removed or minimized, resulting in a cleaner, more professional look. This holds for news (text lists), social feeds (each post separated by a bit of padding and a subtle line), to e-commerce (product listings often just float in a grid with only a shadow on hover to indicate card) – in each case, simplifying the container around items lets user focus on item content.

Emerging convergence: It's also worth noting that certain elements are becoming nearly universal: **dark mode toggles** (content sites, dev tools, even store sites now often have a dark mode option, as user preference for dark mode in low-light has become widespread [40]), **mobile-first design** (designing for small screens and scaling up – a practice now common to all archetypes given mobile traffic dominance in many sectors), and **ARIA/accessibility expectations** (skip links on every page, focus management in modals, etc., are becoming baseline expectations due to better awareness and legal pressures – so patterns from one domain, like making a carousel accessible with arrow keys, are being applied everywhere). The result is that while each archetype tailors to its use-case, the general quality bar and toolkit of patterns for web UX is rising across the board, yielding more common ground in usability while still allowing brand and function differentiation.

4) DELIVERABLE FOR KEY CREATION (RESEARCH-READY)

Global UX Rules (supported by evidence):
- **Use whitespace and subtle dividers instead of heavy boxes** – Favor layout techniques that separate content naturally. For example, top news sites achieve separation with margins and thin lines [8] [16], which makes pages cleaner and more readable than enclosing every item in a card. As a rule, introduce boundaries (lines, backgrounds) only when needed for clarity, not by default for every element.
- **Ensure focus indicators and keyboard nav are intact** – All interactive components must show a visible focus ring or highlight (per WCAG: focus must be visible [41]). Do not remove the default outline without a custom style. Global navigation and menus should be operable via keyboard (arrow-key through dropdowns, Esc to close, etc.), as evidenced by well-coded menus on sites like The Guardian and BBC [22] [23]. Implement "Skip to content" links on page tops for bypassing repetitive headers.
- **Maintain high color contrast & readable type** – Body text should have at least 4.5:1 contrast on backgrounds (e.g., nearly all sites use dark text on light background for main text [13]). Use off-black (#333) on white to reduce glare if needed [26]. Low-contrast styles (e.g., light gray on white) should be limited to non-essential UI (like timestamps or disabled states) and still meet contrast for UI

components (3:1 for graphical object edges under WCAG).
- **Adopt a responsive 8px-based spacing system** – Use a consistent spacing scale (commonly 4px or 8px increments) for padding, margins, grid gutters. This brings visual harmony and easier responsive scaling [33]. Research shows most screens dimensions are multiples of 8, and many design systems (Material, Bootstrap) use 8pt grid for consistency. Globally define spacing tokens (e.g., xs=4px, s=8px, m=16px, l=24px, xl=32px, etc.) and apply throughout – this avoids arbitrary gaps and aligns with industry best practices.
- **Optimize for performance and accessibility in media** – Any auto-playing or animated media should default to muted/no-motion and provide controls. Follow the practice of news sites which keep animations subtle and respect reduced-motion preferences [14] [18]. Lazy-load below-the-fold images and use responsive `<img srcset>` to serve appropriate resolutions (improves load times on mobile). Provide text alternatives: captions or alt text for images (especially infographics) and transcripts for videos/audio, as users may consume content in different modes or have disabilities. Globally, treat performance and a11y not as afterthoughts but as core quality metrics (set budgets for load-time, use automated a11y testing on templates).

Archetype-specific UI Presets:

- **News Publication Preset:** *Layout:* Multi-column (e.g., 3-column: left nav index, main news, right rail for aside content) on desktop, collapsing to single column on mobile. Ample whitespace, 960–1100px content width center for readability. *Typography:* Serif for headlines/body (e.g., Merriweather or Libre Baskerville as free options), with clear hierarchy (headline ~1.5–2× body size). Tone formal; use Title Case in headlines unless style dictates otherwise. *Color:* Predominantly white background, black text. One accent color (e.g., dark blue or red) for section labels or links [15]. *Components:* Use lists for story links (no heavy cards). Top nav bar with sections; secondary nav for subsections if needed. Minimal buttons (most interactions are navigation); primary button style can be a simple filled rectangle in accent color for "Subscribe" or similar CTAs. *Interaction:* Hover states on headlines (underline or light bg). Possibly infinite scroll or paged "load more" on section pages. *Motion:* Very little – maybe smooth scrolling back-to-top, or a slight fade on dropdown menus (keep it under 200ms). *Dark theme:* Usually off by default (reading mode); if provided, invert colors (dark gray background, light text) but keep images and graphics properly adjusted. *Example References:* NYTimes, Guardian – use custom serifs, restrained design.

- **Magazine / Editorial Preset:** *Layout:* One main content column with wider margins (for immersive feel), often a fixed max-width ~700–800px for text blocks to aid long-form reading. Feature stories can break grid (full-bleed images, pull quotes spanning columns). *Typography:* Elegant serif for body (or high-quality webfont like Playfair Display for titles, Georgia for body). Headlines may be significantly larger and stylized (to set the tone) than in news. Tone can be more narrative or witty. Use sentence case if aligning with modern style (many magazines do). *Color:* Lots of white, but more freedom to use background color sections in an article or on category pages (e.g., a light beige behind a fashion story to give a distinct mood). Still, core text on white or very light background for readability. Possibly distinct color per section (culture, tech) as subtle header accent. *Components:* Emphasis on imagery – large hero images, image galleries (with captions) inside articles. Less dense listing on the homepage – maybe a featured article with big image, then a grid of latest stories. Cards can be used tastefully (with magazine-style layout, e.g., Masonry for a section of features). *Interaction:* Encourage scrolling – could include scroll-progress indicator on long reads. Comments may be present but often deprioritized or on separate page (some magazines eschew comments entirely). *Motion:* More experimental allowed in features (parallax images, fade-in of text) since editorial can be experiential (but ensure no motion that impedes reading). *Dark theme:* Typically off; magazines stick to print-like light mode to maintain the aesthetic of their brand photography and art (which is calibrated for light BG). *Example:* The New Yorker's site – lots of white space, classic fonts; *Wired* – bolder, with custom display fonts and sometimes non-traditional layouts but still fundamentally a single column of text for stories.

- **Documentation / Knowledge Base Preset:** *Layout:* Two-column default: left side navigation (hierarchical tree or menu of docs), right side content. Content area max-width ~720px for easy reading of code examples (which often use horizontal scrolling if wider). If on mobile, nav collapses into a hamburger or accordion. *Typography:* Clear sans-serif (developers prefer sans for code contexts – e.g., **Roboto/Source Sans** as body, and a monospaced font for code blocks like **Menlo/Consolas or Fira Code** for ligatures). Slightly larger base font (16px or even 17px) since a lot of reading, and line-height ~1.5 for comfort. Tone: instructional and succinct. Titles often in Sentence case (e.g., "Getting started with the API") to appear informal and straightforward. *Color:* Often a light background (white) for content, with distinctive background for code blocks (e.g., a light gray or mild pastel) to set them apart. Many doc sites use an off-white or light gray page background to be easier on eyes than stark white. Links in a noticeable color (often blue) and clearly underlined (because users scanning documentation rely on recognizing links to related pages). *Components:* Lots of **tables** (for parameters, etc.), styled without heavy borders (just row lines). Collapse/expand sections for long content (like an FAQ style "expand for answer") are common. Search bar prominent (usually at top of sidebar or header) with auto-suggest. Possibly a **version switcher** dropdown (docs often cover multiple versions). Code blocks with "Copy" button in the corner. Callout admonitions (Note/Tip/Warning) with subtle colored left border or icon. *Interaction:* Navigation tree should highlight current page and allow keyboard navigation (many devs tab through). Scrolling can have a "On this page" mini-toc that sticks in view for long pages (to jump to sections). No fancy animation – instant or snappy transitions (devs prefer quick, non-flashy UIs). *Motion:* Essentially none aside from maybe smooth scroll for anchor links. Respect user preferences – if any auto-running scripts or interactive demos, don't overwhelm. *Dark theme:* Highly requested in dev circles – many documentation platforms now have dark mode toggle (or auto if system preference) because devs may read docs in low-light or just prefer it [36]. Ensure code block color themes invert properly. *Examples:* MDN Web Docs (free font, mostly sans, and a toggle for dark; clear structure), ReadTheDocs (very standard left-nav, simple content area), Stripe API docs (sans + monospaced, minimal color, excellent formatting of code).

- **Wiki / Reference Preset:** *Layout:* Very content-heavy and utilitarian. Typically a wide single column for content with a right rail for meta info or an in-page TOC (Wikipedia does this on wide screens). Top of page might have a search bar and category breadcrumbs. Consistent layout across pages is key (since content is user-generated or varied). *Typography:* System fonts or basic sans-serif for UI and often serif for content in references – Wikipedia, for instance, uses sans-serif for interface and allows either serif or sans for content via settings (default is sans on many devices for neutrality). A neutral font like **Helvetica/Arial or Segoe UI** for body keeps it simple (avoid anything looking branded). *Tone:* Absolutely factual and impersonal. Often uses sentence case for titles (except Proper Nouns). *Color:* Minimalistic. White background, black text. Link color standard blue (unvisited) / purple (visited) is actually still seen on Wikipedia, as it's an established convention – it may look dated, but it's highly functional for reference use (knowing what you clicked). No background colors in content except maybe light yellow for highlighted search terms or template messages. *Components:* Table of contents for longer pages (auto-generated and placed at top). Lots of inline links (so styling must differentiate them clearly from text – underline or blue). Templates/infoboxes in articles (like a side infobox with gray background on Wikipedia). Possibly collapsible sections for long lists (e.g., "show more"). Edit buttons appear as small links or icons (if user has permission) – so the UI accommodates both readers and editors. *Interaction:*

Not interactive in fancy way – clicking an anchor scrolls instantly, clicking a link goes to page load (no SPAs here). Some wikis have section edit links that appear on hover (requiring focus handling too for accessibility). The priority is that any user with any browser (even old ones or assistive tech) can access the content – so it's built in a progressively enhanced way (plain HTML links, etc.). *Motion:* Essentially none. Maybe a subtle JavaScript to smooth-scroll but even that is often avoided for simplicity. *Dark mode:* Traditionally not present (Wikipedia only introduced an official dark mode recently via preference). Many reference sites assume printing or old monitors. But modern redesigns may add dark theme option for heavy users (Wiki has community-made skins for dark). *Examples:* Wikipedia (classic reference design), WikiHow (somewhat more styled but still content-first), Britannica (a bit more modern fonts and a nicer layout but fundamentally similar structure of title – content – related links).

- **Blog / Creator Article Preset:** *Layout:* A central single column for content (typically ~600-700px width for easy reading), with optional sidebars for profile info or latest posts (on desktop). The homepage might be a list of recent posts (either titles + excerpts or a grid of featured images). Many personal blogs use a simple chronological list layout. *Typography:* Often serif for titles and sans or serif for body depending on aesthetic – e.g., tech blogs might go sans-serif throughout (for a clean, modern feel), while a food or travel blog might use a serif for a more editorial vibe. Readability is key: at least 16px text. Line length ~70-80 characters. Line spacing comfortable. *Tone:* Very personal and informal (first-person, witty or narrative titles). That influences microcopy (e.g., "Filed under: Cooking Tips" instead of just "Category: Cooking"). Titles might be in Title Case or Sentence case – there's no strict rule, it's stylistic (many modern blogs use Sentence case for a conversational tone). *Color:* Usually a light background (white or pastel) and a distinctive accent that reflects personality (a bright color for links or headings). It's common to see more playful color usage than in corporate sites – e.g., links in coral pink or teal if it matches the blogger's brand, rather than default blue. But still, content area generally stays high contrast (dark text on light). *Components:* **Comments** section at bottom (if enabled) – styling for comments often nested with slight indent or light gray background alternating. Social share buttons on top or side of posts (small icon buttons). Perhaps an "About the author" blurb at bottom with an avatar. Sidebar (if present) might include a small bio, search box, tag cloud, or list of categories – these are common blog widgets. Navigation is usually simple: a top menu with Home, About, Contact, and maybe categories or uses a hamburger if minimal. *Interaction:* Not intensive – reading and commenting are main interactions. Comment forms should be straightforward (Name, Email, Comment fields). If infinite scroll is used on listing pages, it should still provide ways to reach footer (some blogs choose manual "Load more" to avoid trapping readers). For engagement, might include "Like this post" or "Subscribe to newsletter" pop-ups – these should be subtle (many blogs do a small slide-up prompt after scrolling 50%). *Motion:* Typically minimal – perhaps a fade-in effect on images as they load or a smooth scroll back-to-top button. Because blogs are often run on platforms like WordPress, any added motion tends to come from theme features or plugins (e.g., a lightbox for images might have a zoom animation). The emphasis is on content, so nothing should detract from reading flow. *Dark mode:* Rarely default, but some personal sites allow toggling dark mode (especially tech bloggers who know how to implement it – they do it to be reader-friendly). It's a nice-to-have, but not ubiquitous yet in personal blogs. *Examples:* A personal tech blog (e.g., Dan Abramov's Overreacted – uses a casual serif for text and a dark mode toggle), a food blog (often lots of photos with a clean sans-serif and maybe pastel backgrounds for recipe cards), Medium's default article style (very spaced out, one column, clear typography) has influenced many independent blogs.

- **App Marketplace / Storefront Preset:** *Layout:* A **search bar** dominated interface with product listings in either grid or list. Expect a header with search and category navigation (possibly a sidebar or horizontal category menu). Content zone showing filters on left (desktop) and product cards taking up rest. On mobile, filters become a slide-out panel or a top "Filter" button, and products show in a two-column grid. *Typography:* Clean sans-serif (selling apps/games is a modern context, and sans feels techy and neutral – e.g., Google Play uses Roboto, Apple App Store uses its San Francisco, Steam uses a mix but largely sans UI). Font size medium (~14px) so that a lot can be listed without overwhelming. Titles of apps might be a bit heavier weight to stand out, with secondary info (developer, price) lighter. *Color:* White or very neutral background to let app icon graphics pop (Play Store is very white; Steam is dark but that's as much to do with its gaming aesthetic and to showcase colorful game art). Accent colors often match brand (Google's blue, Apple's gray/blue scheme). Rating stars typically colored (e.g., yellow stars). Sale prices might be in red to attract attention (marketplaces often use red/strike-through for discounts). *Components:* **Product/App card** with icon, name, rating, price, maybe a "Install" or "Buy" button directly. Possibly a carousel for "Featured" apps at top (with big banners). Filtering controls: checkboxes, sliders (for price or rating), drop-downs for sort (e.g., sort by popularity or release date). Pagination or infinite scroll for results – many use infinite scroll to encourage browsing (Steam uses pagination for category browsing on web; mobile app stores use infinite). Also user-generated content components: star rating display, count of reviews, maybe a snippet of top review on the app detail page. The app detail page itself is like a mini-landing page: image gallery (with swipe or click thumbnails), description text (often collapsible to show more), and tabs or sections for reviews, what's new, etc. *Interaction:* Very search and filter heavy – likely keyboard shortcuts for search focus on desktop, and dynamic updating of results when a filter is checked (without full page reload). Adding to cart or wish-lists for paid items is a key interaction – those should give feedback (e.g., "Added to cart" toast, or cart icon updates). Because marketplaces often involve sign-in and purchasing flows, **onboarding modals** and multi-step forms (address, payment) must be smooth (with clear progress indicators). *Motion:* Use motion to enhance perceived performance: load spinners or skeleton screens when loading results, subtle animations when adding an item to cart (e.g., an icon flying to cart – Amazon does minimal, others do none or a simple plus-one animation). Carousels auto-rotate gently (with user control to pause). Mobile app stores often have nice swiping physics for image galleries. These sites avoid overly flashy transitions; they prioritize quick browsing (so, for instance, Steam's web store is fairly static except some hover zoom effects on images). *Dark mode:* Not standard except in platforms targeting devs/gamers (Steam has a dark theme, some developer-oriented markets might offer it). Play Store and App Store on mobile follow device theme, but on web, Play Store is light-only as of research. If audience could be browsing at night (gamers), consider a dark mode. *Examples:* Google Play (clean, card-based, white), Apple App Store web (lots of white, product showcase pages with custom layout), Steam (darker, info-dense, with big visual carousels for featured games), Microsoft Store (light, adaptive to Windows light/dark modes, simple grid of tiles).

- **E-commerce Retail Preset:** *Layout:* Typically a **grid of product cards** for category pages, with a left sidebar for filters (collapsed to filter menus on mobile). A prominent hero or featured product carousel on the homepage. Header includes logo on left, big search bar in middle (search is crucial in retail), and cart icon + user account on right. Use a 12-column grid or similar on desktop to allow 3-4 product cards per row with gutters. *Typography:* Clear and utilitarian. Generally sans-serif (e.g., Amazon uses Amazon Ember, a sans; Walmart uses a straightforward sans). Font size around 14px for body so product titles (which can be long) fit nicely. Emphasis via weight on product names and prices. Avoid overly stylized fonts – needs to be easy to scan quickly. *Color:* Brand colors for accents (Amazon's orange for prices/add-to-cart, Walmart's blue for buttons, etc.). But backgrounds almost always white for product listings, with neutral grays for borders and shading so that product images (often on white backgrounds themselves) stand out. Error messages (like "out of stock") in red or other high-contrast color. Promotional banners can use more vibrant color (sale banner in red or yellow). *Components:* **Product card**: includes product image, title (often truncated after 2 lines), star rating icon+count, price (possibly crossed-out original price and highlighted sale price), and maybe a quick "Add to cart" button or wishlist heart. Filtering panel: multi-select checkboxes for attributes (size, brand), sliders for price, color swatches for color filter, etc., plus a "Clear all filters" option. Sorting dropdown (by price, popularity, etc.). **Product detail page**: high-quality image gallery (zoom on hover or click-to-zoom, thumbnails below or aside), product title, a block of reviews summary, price and any variant selectors (size dropdowns, color selection), quantity picker, and an **Add to Cart** button which is styled as the primary CTA (large, full-width on mobile, distinct color). Also supports secondary actions like "Add to wishlist". Below, detailed description, specs table, and user reviews section (with pagination or lazy-load). Possibly Q&A section. Checkout flow: multi-step form (shipping -> payment -> review) with progress indicator. This form should use well-known patterns (e.g., same layout as address forms on other sites for familiarity). *Interaction:* Users often compare items: enabling easy opening of product pages in new tabs or a "compare" feature is good. Add-to-cart should give feedback – e.g., an animation or at least an in-page confirmation ("Added! Go to Cart or Continue Shopping"). If an item is out of stock or selection invalid, show inline messages next to the relevant field (don't only on form submit). Use tooltips or hover popovers for quick info (some sites show a quick "Quick view" of a product on hover as a modal – though some UX research says these modals can annoy, it's common on fashion sites). Ensure keyboard navigation on forms (tab order logical) and ARIA for things like star rating controls. *Motion:* In retail, motion is used to delight and also to convey state changes: e.g., a little cart icon "shake" when something added, or a heart icon filling when added to wishlist. Avoid long transitions that slow browsing – users often want to flip through items quickly. Carousel auto-advance should allow manual navigation easily (include arrows). Form interactions (like selecting a different color swapping the product image) should be quick and might use a fade or slide transition for the image change to make it noticeable but not jarring. *Dark mode:* Rare in retail – most shopping sites stick to light (partly convention, partly because product photography is done assuming light background). If a site's brand is dark-themed (some luxury fashion sites use dark mode styling to appear sleek), that's a deliberate design, but not an alternate mode. Generally, focus on a great light mode unless brand dictates otherwise. *Examples:* Amazon (maximizes info, somewhat cluttered but very functional), Apple's online store (lots of whitespace, very high-end feel, big images), Zara's site (fashion, uses a lot of white, minimal text for a chic feel), and Shopify template examples (which often set the standard for clean small-business e-com: clear grids, prominent product imagery).

- **Streaming Video Platform Preset:** *Layout:* **Gallery of thumbnails** is the core. Often a series of horizontal carousels by category (Netflix style) – each with a row title on left and scroll arrows on right. Or a mosaic grid if browsing all. A persistent video player interface when content is playing (usually controls overlay on video, auto-hide). TV platforms favor horizontal navigation (since 16:9 thumbnails fit well in rows), while web may mix some vertical scrolling with horizontal sections. *Typography:* Largely sans-serif, bold for titles. Very short text (just titles of shows, maybe episode names) so font is chosen more for style matching brand than for heavy readability. Netflix uses Helvetica/Roboto on devices; Disney+ uses its own clean sans. Text is often white on dark background (because streaming interfaces are usually dark themed to reduce glare in low-light viewing). Small font for metadata (year, rating, etc.) below thumbnails. *Color:* Dark background (#000 to #111) to let cover art pop and to be easy on eyes when watching in dark environments [36]. Vibrant highlight colors for focus states or selection (e.g., Netflix's red, Disney's blue). Progress bars in video player in a standout color (YouTube's red seek bar is iconic). *Components:* **Thumbnail cards** for each video with an image (cover/poster), possibly with a hover effect to show more info or auto-play a preview (Netflix does auto-preview video on hover – requires careful UX but it engages users). A play button overlay often appears on hover/focus. Navigation menu might be minimal text or icons (Home, Series, Movies, My List).

Search is important – often an icon that expands to a search field with suggestions (YouTube shows live suggestions including videos, channels). The video player: standard controls (play/pause, timeline slider, volume, settings gear, full-screen). Also features like “Next Episode” countdown, subtitles toggle (with an accessible menu). If multiple user profiles, a profile selector on startup or in corner. *Interaction:* **Left/right scrolling** within carousels (with mouse drag or arrows). On TV or keyboard, arrow keys navigate between items (horizontally within a row, vertically to move to next row). Ensuring good focus management is key (like an active outline or scale-up on the focused thumbnail). Autoplay behaviors: after finishing an episode, next one auto-plays (with a cancel option). For movies, recommended titles might show. For web (YouTube-style), infinite scroll of related videos in sidebar or below the player to keep engagement. Search results often show as you type, so an autosuggest list with titles and maybe thumbnail. *Motion:* Heavy use of motion for transitions – e.g., on focusing a show card, maybe it enlarges or plays a short video preview (Netflix/Prime do this). Background fade when opening a details modal. Smooth slide-out of side menus. Motion is used to create a fluid, TV-like experience (snappy and immersive). However, allow users to disable auto-preview if possible (Netflix added an option after feedback). Easing tends to be ease-out for snappy feel, and durations short (<300ms) for navigational moves (because user might be quickly moving between many items). *Dark mode:* Default is dark for most (Netflix, Prime, Disney+ all dark backgrounds). Some user-generated content platforms like YouTube have both modes, but increasingly even YouTube has been pushing dark theme for consistent experience across devices. So in this archetype, dark is not an “alternate” – it’s often the primary design. *Examples:* Netflix (benchmark for carousel layout and preview on focus), YouTube (benchmark for user content + web features like comments, but lighter background on default web – though it has dark mode), Disney+ (great unified branding, each franchise has slight theme but overall dark blue/black UI), Twitch (dark with purple accents, lots of real-time chat and interactive overlay elements on video).

- **Music Player / Library App Preset:** *Layout:* A **sidebar + main view** is common (sidebar for library/playlists, main for content list or now playing). E.g., Spotify has left sidebar for navigation (Home, Browse, Your Library) and playlists, main area for the current view (album list, recommendations), and an always-present bottom player bar. Mobile likely uses tab bar (Library, Search, Home) and now-playing bar at bottom that can expand to full player. *Typography:* Sans-serif, medium-sized (music apps often use slightly smaller font to fit lists of songs – around 13px – but make sure it’s readable). Track names might be slightly bold. There’s a lot of metadata (artist, album, duration), often differentiated by weight or color (e.g., track title white, artist gray). Apple Music uses the San Francisco font which is tight and clean; Spotify uses its custom Circular/Spotify Sans with slightly looser, friendlier feel. *Color:* Many music apps use dark mode by default (Spotify’s dark grey/green, Apple Music’s black/red on mobile). Dark UIs help put focus on album art colors and also feel “cool” for music. But web players (like old Pandora site) used light theme; YouTube Music uses dark by default. Accent color usually for play controls or highlights (Spotify’s green, Apple Music uses pink/red accents, YouTube Music orange/red progress bar). If theme adapts to content (some apps change background based on album art dominant color), ensure contrast is maintained. *Components:* **Media list** – a scrolling list of songs or albums. Could be plain list or grid (albums often grid of covers, tracks a list with columns). Each item clickable to play or expand options (three-dot menu for actions like Add to playlist, Share). A fixed **player control bar** with play/pause, skip, shuffle, repeat icons, volume control, and a seek slider with current time/total time. Possibly lyrics pane or visualization toggle. Search function for songs/artists with real-time filtering of library. Playlist creation dialogs (simple input + list selection). Transitions between views often animated (cover art enlarges from list to now-playing view). Micro-interactions: clicking a heart “likes” a song (toggle icon fill). Drag-and-drop: reordering playlist tracks or dragging tracks onto playlist name to add (desktop UX). *Interaction:*

Continuous playback is core – so UI often gives feedback on what's playing in list views (highlighting the current track). Keyboard shortcuts: space to play/pause, arrow keys or media keys to skip – web players often implement these. Right-click context menus on tracks provide rich options (especially in desktop web player). Real-time updates: if another device changes the song (multi-device sync like Spotify Connect), the UI updates state. Social aspects: showing what friends are listening (sidebar or profile features) – optional but some players have a friend feed requiring profile pics and names in UI. *Motion:* Seamless transitions are valued (music apps strive for a slick feel). Examples: animated playback bars icon on currently playing track, smooth sliding of content area when navigating (Spotify's desktop slides panels, Apple Music does a card-like modal for Now Playing on mobile). Microanimation on pressing play (button morphs from play to pause with a nice easing). Visualizers or background animations for effect (Apple Music on Apple TV shows moving artwork backgrounds). Typically ~300ms ease-in-out for UI transitions, and often synchronized with music where possible (but that's more experimental). *Dark mode:* Usually default to dark as mentioned. If a light mode is offered, it's fully designed (e.g., Apple Music on iOS is actually light themed in many parts, whereas desktop iTunes was light – but the trend is going dark for immersive media). Provide both if possible but design primarily for one (Spotify only has dark official theme). *Examples:* Spotify (pioneered many modern patterns in music streaming UX), Apple Music (blends iOS design language with music features, now leaning dark on desktop), SoundCloud (lighter, with unique waveform player and emphasis on comments – a different take because of its social focus), YouTube Music (basically a re-skinned YouTube web with music-centric library and recommendations, using dark theme by default).

- **Email Client Preset:** *Layout:* Three-pane classic: left sidebar with mailboxes/folders, center pane list of emails, right pane reading view (on smaller screens, it collapses to two-pane or one-pane). Alternatively, some have two-pane (list + read, with folder list as a collapsible menu). The interface is information-dense but must remain clear. *Typography:* Sans-serif (emails are legibility-focused). Gmail and Outlook use sans (Arial, etc.) with 13px or so text for email snippets. Unread emails often bold in list. Use monospace only for specific cases (maybe in compose window for plain text?). Ensure good contrast for read vs unread (unread often black text, read a gray). *Color:* Generally light theme by default (white background for list and reading area) with accent colors for highlights (Gmail uses blue for selection, Outlook uses a blue theme). Some clients allow theme change or background images, but base design assumes neutral colors. Flags or labels use colors (e.g., Gmail labels are colored tags). Error or alert messages (like "Email not sent") in red. *Components:* **Mailbox list**: tree of folders/labels with counts (perhaps in lighter text or a pill). Possibly icons for standard folders (📥 for Inbox). **Email list/table**: each row shows sender, subject, maybe a snippet, timestamp, and perhaps icons for attachments or importance. Clicking opens email in reading pane or full view. Each row might have a checkbox for selection and star icon for quick flag. There's often a toolbar above the list for actions (Delete, Archive, Mark as read, etc.) that activates when emails are selected. **Reading pane:** shows the email content, with a header (From, To, Cc, Subject) styled clearly (From in bold, others smaller). Attachments either show as file name chips or thumbnails below the header. Reply controls at top or bottom (e.g., quick reply box, or a Reply button that opens compose). **Compose window:** either a modal (Gmail's compose is a small window over the mailbox) or a dedicated full editor pane. It will have fields for To/Cc/Bcc (with autocomplete dropdowns when typing addresses), a subject field, and a rich text editor area with formatting toolbar. The send button is prominently colored (blue in many clients). *Interaction:* A lot of keyboard shortcut support (e.g., "N" for new email, "Ctrl+Enter" to send, arrow keys to navigate emails) – power users expect this, so hints or an online cheat sheet is good. Drag-and-drop: dragging emails to folders to move them, or attachments onto the compose window to attach. Multi-select via checkboxes or Shift+select range. Inline actions: e.g., clicking the star icon to toggle important without opening an email (so those icons should update instantly and perhaps animate a star fill). Real-time feedback: after sending, show a small toast “Message sent – Undo” with the ability to undo send (which in Gmail is just delaying actual send) [42] . If new mail arrives, many clients highlight the Inbox or show a notification; the UI might insert the new email in the list with subtle highlight (some flash or background shade that fades). *Motion:* Fairly minimal and utilitarian – quick fades or slides. Gmail’s new design used a subtle slide in/out for side panels. But because efficiency is key, most actions feel instant. One place where motion is helpful: showing an email “slide” out of the list when archived or deleted, to give a cue it’s been moved (Outlook web does a quick slide-left + fade on delete). Also, a loading spinner or progress for syncing. *Dark mode:* Becoming common (Outlook, Gmail apps have dark mode; Gmail web introduced official dark theme via Chrome settings). So providing a dark theme is good for users reading at night, but ensure HTML email content (which might have fixed colors) is handled (some clients invert colors for email body, which can be tricky). *Examples:* Gmail (pioneered threaded conversations, uses a clean mostly-white interface with Material Design touches), Outlook.com (more skeuomorphic of desktop Outlook, with solid lines and more obvious buttons – appeals to classic users), ProtonMail (very similar to Gmail in layout, with emphasis on security indicators). All generally follow the same tri-pane baseline with small stylistic differences.

- **Messaging / Chat App Preset:** *Layout:* **Sidebar (or list) of conversations + chat panel**. For personal mobile-oriented apps (WhatsApp, Messenger), typically a list view of chats, then full-screen chat when opened (back to list). For desktop/work chat (Slack, Teams), a left sidebar of channels/DMs, a header/top bar for the current conversation, the main message history pane, and a message input box at the bottom. Possibly a right sidebar for thread or info when invoked. *Typography:* Sans-serif, relatively small (12–14px) because chat is text-heavy and need to fit timestamps and names. Use weight and color to distinguish speakers vs text. E.g., Slack uses username in bold and slightly different color than message text. System messages or date dividers often in italic or smaller font. Ensure emojis render well (some apps use custom emoji font/sprites). *Color:* Each app often has signature color for accents (Slack purple/orange, WhatsApp green). But message bubbles or background are typically light for one party and slightly colored for the other to differentiate speakers (e.g., iMessage: gray bubbles for you, blue for me – or in group Slack, each user not colored differently, but perhaps name text has a color). Dark vs light theme: many chat apps offer both (Slack default light, optional dark; Discord default dark). Light theme usually has very light background for chat area, and uses colored text or subtle bubble for incoming vs outgoing. Choose a palette that’s not too distracting – content (the text) should dominate. Notifications (unread badge counts) are often red circles. Links in messages in blue and underlined. *Components:* **Chat bubble or message row:** shows sender name (if group), message text (support for multi-line, maybe markdown formatting), timestamp (either to the side or on hover). Possibly message status (check marks for delivered/read in WhatsApp). **Input box:** multi-line text field with placeholder (e.g., “Type a message…”), plus icons for attachments, emoji picker, maybe mic (for audio message). **Headers:** conversation header with either contact name + status (online/offline or last seen) and buttons for call, video, info. **Sidebar list:** each conversation listed with contact name, maybe photo, recent message snippet, and a timestamp or badge for unread. Likely a filter/search field on top of chat list to quickly find conversations. If supporting threads (Slack), each message might have a “Reply in thread” button appearing on hover, opening a secondary pane. Possibly features like message reactions (emoji reaction counts) which appear below or on messages – those need clear affordances (small emoji icon you can click to add your own, hovering shows who reacted, etc.). *Interaction:* Very real-time – new messages should append instantly with a subtle scroll animation. Typing indicator (e.g., “… is typing” with animated ellipsis) to show activity. Read receipts – e.g., small avatar icons under last read message to indicate up to where someone read (common in Slack threads). Selecting text should allow copy – and there may be message-specific menu (e.g., right-click or “…” menu on each message for actions like edit, delete, pin). Drag-and-drop of files onto the chat to upload. Keyboard support: Enter to send (with Shift+Enter for newline typically), arrow up to edit last message (in Slack/Discord). Hotkeys like Ctrl+K to jump to another chat, etc., if a power-user app. On mobile, swiping conversation list items could archive or other actions (like iOS patterns). *Motion:* Quick and context-appropriate. Message arrival might have a brief highlight or bounce (some apps do a tiny flash for a new message to draw your eye). Transitions between chat and list on mobile slide in/out horizontally. Opening an image or lightbox could fade in. But too much animation can slow down rapid chatting, so these are kept minimal and can often be toggled. Possibly playful animations for certain emoji or keywords (e.g., Messenger's thumbs-up sends an animation). *Dark mode:* Very common in this space. Many chat apps default to light but offer dark; some (like Discord) default to dark due to user base preference. Dark mode uses dark gray backgrounds (#2e2e2e etc.) for chat and even darker for sidebars, with user name text in slight color (to differentiate multiple speakers) and message text in lighter gray/white. Ensure chosen colors for different users or roles have sufficient contrast in both modes. *Examples:* Slack (business chat, lots of features like threads, reactions, robust keyboard shortcuts), WhatsApp (simple personal chat, streamlined for quick photo/audio sharing, has to be extremely easy to use), Discord (community chat with emphasis on voice channels and gaming integration, with a dark neon aesthetic and some different info architecture for servers). All share core patterns of list+chat and continuous scrolling content.

- **Social Feed (timeline) Preset:** *Layout:* Typically a single main feed column (centered on wide screens with side gutters for trends or ads). Infinite scroll by default – new posts load as you scroll [34]. Each post is a "card" of content: user info, content (text/image/video), engagement buttons, comments below. Navigation via a fixed top bar (with logo, search, maybe posting button, profile avatar). Often an aside on desktop for secondary info (trending topics, who to follow). *Typography:* Sans-serif, medium size (~14-16px for post text for readability on mobile). Short posts might be larger (Twitter uses slightly larger text for tweets vs UI chrome). Use of bold for usernames or not? (Twitter uses a bold name and @handle lighter; Facebook uses people's names in plain weight but strong color). Overall, legibility and consistency matter (Twitter and Facebook both standardized on simple system-like fonts for most text). Emojis and hashtags inline need to be clearly rendered (hashtags often highlighted color or at least linked). *Color:* Predominantly light background (white or very light gray). Each brand has accent (Twitter blue, Facebook blue, etc.) used for active elements (selected tab, buttons). But content like images or videos bring in lots of colors, so UI chrome stays neutral. Link text typically the brand color (Twitter hashtags and mentions in blue). On heavy content like long threads, alternating background for comments might be used (Facebook lightly shades replies background to distinguish nested comments). *Components:* **Post unit:** includes header (avatar, name, maybe privacy indicator or group name, timestamp with dropdown arrow for post options), body (text, which may have see more/collapse if long), media if any (photo grid or one big image, or an embedded link preview with thumbnail), then **engagement bar:** e.g., Like, Comment, Share buttons with icons and counts [43]. Comments thread expands below (often a few top comments visible with a "View more comments" link). **Stories** (on platforms that have ephemeral stories) appear as tappable circles usually at top of feed (Instagram, Facebook). **Composer**: at top of feed, a field saying "What's on your mind?" with options to attach images, etc., which either expands inline or opens a modal to create a new post. **Notifications** often in a separate panel accessible via top bar icon (a dropdown showing recent likes/comments, etc., each as a short item to click). Possibly a right sidebar with trends or suggestions (Twitter trends list, Facebook trending or ads). *Interaction:* Scrolling is primary. Tapping anywhere on a post opens the detail (if it's a detailed view context, like Twitter focuses a tweet). Buttons: Like toggles filled vs not (with a quick animation, e.g., FB's reaction explosions, Twitter's heart burst). Comment button focuses the comment input. Share/Retweet pops a dialog or menu for options. Infinite scroll means when user reaches bottom, load more seamlessly; also if new posts come in, either auto-insert

(Twitter shows a "See new tweets" button when new content is available above). Feedback: after posting, show the new post immediately in feed (optimistic UI). For error states (failed to post), show a retry banner on the post. Real-time: on some platforms (Facebook), if people are commenting while you view, it may live-update the comment count or insert new comments. But this is often limited. *Motion:* Social apps experiment with fun animations (e.g., reaction emojis animate, like holding down Like on FB opens reaction menu with bouncing icons). But basic navigation is snappy (no waiting). Transitions between pages might be just instant or a simple slide (mobile native apps do nice slides; web often just reloads or uses quick client-side route transitions). Story UIs use a subtle progress bar at top that animates. Ads or video might auto-play as you scroll into view, but muted. *Dark mode:* Many social platforms now offer it (Twitter, Reddit, etc.) due to user demand and high time spent. It's often not default except maybe Reddit's redesign pushes dark if system is dark. But having it is good – it inverts background to dark and text to light, while keeping brand colors (Twitter's blue) somewhat but sometimes they offer alternative palettes (Twitter has even "lights out" black vs dark gray options). For consistency, design both modes with accessible contrasts. *Examples:* Facebook (mix of text, photo, link posts, heavy on engagement features), Twitter (mostly text, with media well-integrated, simpler engagement—likes/retweets— and very fast interactions), Instagram (mostly image grid or one-column feed with minimal text aside from captions, heavy on stories and reels). Differences: FB is feature-rich (groups, marketplace etc. in one app), Twitter is simpler feed + trending, Instagram visual-first. But all share core timeline mechanics and iterative improvement of existing patterns (e.g., infinite scroll, pull-to-refresh on mobile, etc.).

- **Short-form Video Feed Preset:** *Layout:* **Vertical video player** taking most of screen, with minimal UI overlays. Typically portrait video 9:16. On the right side or bottom, floating icons for Like, Comment, Share, and perhaps creator profile. At bottom, a caption text overlay and music info. Swipe up/down to move to next/prev video (no explicit scroll bar since content is full-screen). This is the TikTok/Reels paradigm. Alternatively, some implement as a scrollable feed of video thumbnails, but the trend is the immersive single-video view with swipe navigation. *Typography:* Bold sans-serif for on-screen labels (e.g., track name, or "Follow" button). Caption text often rendered over video in a shade (ensuring readability via stroke or shadow). Since video content itself might include text (subtitles etc.), the app's own text is outlined or contrasted. Generally minimal text – just username (maybe bold), caption (regular weight, smaller), and on-screen hashtags (colored or same style as caption). Font sizes fairly large because viewing at arm's length on mobile (TikTok's caption font ~16px). *Color:* Interface chrome is usually white text/icons on dark translucent gradients (to ensure it shows on any video). E.g., TikTok places white icons with subtle shadows so they're visible on bright or dark video frames. Brand color used for highlights (e.g., TikTok's pink/blue on icons when active, or the record spinning icon has color). The background behind videos is black (or very dark) to avoid any border; the video fills the view. *Components:* **Video player** that auto-plays on load (with sound on by default typically). Tapping pauses/plays (or toggles UI visibility, depending on app). **Engagement icons:** usually stacked on right: Like heart, Comment (speech bubble), Share (arrow), plus maybe profile picture (which if tapped leads to profile) and a rotating disc icon for the music track (tap to see other videos with that sound). On bottom left: Creator name (with maybe a follow + button near it), the caption text with hashtags, and the sound name. Possibly a "Discover" or "For You" toggle at top to switch feeds (TikTok has that). Pull-to-refresh to get new recommendations if at top of feed. Some apps add a progress bar at very top for video length or for stories (multiple segments). **Recording interface** (if within same app): that's a different mode – a camera screen with record controls, effects, timeline – but for consumption mode those are hidden. *Interaction:* Pure swipe to navigate – flick up for next video (with a springy transition possibly). Double-tap to like (common gesture, with a heart animation feedback). Comments might slide up in an overlay or open a dedicated comment screen. Sharing opens native share sheet or app's own network share options. The interface is highly optimized for one-handed use (on mobile, right-side icons for thumb reach, bottom caption for easy scanning). On desktop (TikTok web), they mimic mobile view with some padding – but primary use is mobile. *Motion:* The whole experience is motion – video is always playing. UI elements may appear/disappear quickly (controls hide to give full view of video until tapped). Swiping between videos might have a quick 100ms transition (some do a swiping animation, others just cut). Floating elements might slightly animate (e.g., the like icon bursts when you tap). The record disk rotates slowly (TikTok's music disc spins). Given the content itself is dynamic, the app UI doesn't use elaborate transitions that compete – keep it snappy and let the videos be the animation. *Dark mode:* Typically default to dark because it's media-focused (TikTok, Snapchat, etc., use dark interfaces to make videos pop and because people often watch in low light). The UI in light mode might not even exist for some (Instagram's Reels follow device theme though, since Instagram overall has both). But designing primarily for dark is expected – using white icons/text on black. *Examples:* TikTok (pioneered the format – minimal text, all focus on video, algorithmic feed), Instagram Reels (almost identical UI to TikTok when viewing reels, integrated in IG app), YouTube Shorts (in YouTube app, uses similar swipe UI but with YouTube's styling – e.g., red progress bar for multi-segment or slight differences in icons). All emphasize quick, **addictive swiping** and easy interaction (like/comment) with large tappable areas.

Token Ranges & Theming Guidelines:

- **Spacing & Sizing Tokens:** Adopting an 8px grid (or 4px for fine increments) provides consistency [33]. Use base unit `8px`: small padding = 4px (0.5x), standard gutter/margin = 16px (2x), larger section padding = 24px (3x) or 32px (4x) depending on density desired. For example, news sites might use 16px margin between story list items, whereas a social feed might use 8px since card has its own padding. Define fluid container widths: e.g., content max-width tokens like `max-sm: 600px` for narrow reading columns (docs, blogs), `max-md: 900px` for general content, `max-lg: 1200px` for app layouts – these prevent too-wide text lines. Establish line-height tokens: e.g., body text line-height ~1.5 (150%) for comfortable reading, headings tighter ~1.2.

- **Border & Radius Tokens:** Generally, use hairline borders (1px) in a light gray (`#e0e0e0`) for dividers when needed (e.g., table grids, list separators). Corner radii: modern UIs often use subtle rounding (e.g., `radius-sm:4px` for small buttons or cards, `radius-md:8px` for modals or large surfaces). Some archetypes (like landing pages) might go with completely square or very round for stylistic choice, but a safe, modern default is 4–6px on interactive elements (inputs, buttons) to feel friendly but not overly pill-shaped. Shadows token: if using shadows, define a standard subtle shadow for raised elements like modals or floating buttons (e.g., `shadow-md: 0 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.15)`). Many content-heavy sites avoid strong shadows altogether (flat design), but dashboards and modals benefit from one for depth.

- **Surface colors (Light/Dark ladder):** Define a semantic color scale for backgrounds: e.g., `surface-0: #FFFFFF` (main content background), `surface-1: #F5F5F5` (secondary backgrounds like sidebars or alternate row), `surface-2: #EAEAEA` (hover highlight or tertiary backgrounds). In dark theme, these would invert: `surface-0: #121212`, `surface-1: #1E1E1E`, `surface-2: #2A2A2A`, etc. These ensure a consistent hierarchy of contrast. Many archetypes share this approach – e.g., docs site might use surface-0 for page, surface-1 for code blocks. Ensure text colors meet contrast on each surface: e.g., body text on light surface should be ~#212121 (dark gray) for comfortable contrast [26], on dark surface should be #EEE. Define semantic text colors: `text-primary` (body text), `text-secondary` (less important text like metadata – often 70% of primary's opacity or a gray), `text-inverse` (text on dark backgrounds, e.g., white).

- **Accent & State Colors:** Each archetype can customize accent but should stay consistent and not overuse. E.g., a banking app might use a trustable blue as primary accent (for links, buttons), whereas a creative portfolio might use a vibrant color matching branding. Establish about 1–2 accent colors: `accent-primary` for main interactive elements, `accent-secondary` if needed (e.g., a contrasting action or a secondary brand color). State colors tokens across archetypes: `success: #4BB543` (green) for confirmations, `error: #E04B4A` (red) for errors, `warning: #F1C40F` (yellow) for cautions. These should be accessible (e.g., error red meets contrast on white and also has an icon perhaps).

- **Typography Scale:** Set a base font-size ~16px (100%) for body. Define heading sizes with a modular scale (e.g., H1 ~32px (2rem) for big titles, H2 24px, H3 19px, H4 16px bold, etc.). The exact scale might differ by archetype: Landing pages and magazines might have larger display headings (even 3rem, 4rem for hero text) [4] [5], whereas dashboards and docs keep headings more modest to maintain hierarchy without wasting vertical space. Decide on a font pairing: e.g., use a sans-serif (like **Inter** or **Helvetica Neue**) for UI and possibly a serif (like **Georgia** or **Merriweather**) for long-form content in blogs or news, if that fits brand. But limit to 2 families to avoid performance hits and inconsistency. Use system fonts where possible for performance unless brand demands custom. Also define font-weight usage: normal (400) for body, semi-bold (600) for subtitles or emphasized text, bold (700) for section titles. Many products use a semi-bold for labels to differentiate from body without going all the way to bold.

By adhering to these tokens and presets, the design will maintain consistency and flexibility. The evidence from top sites backs these choices: e.g., an 8px grid keeps layouts organized [33], high contrast text ensures readability [13], and proper semantic coloring improves UX (like using red only for errors or critical alerts, as users associate it with that meaning). This research-driven key will ensure that the UI not only looks professional and avoids common pitfalls ("boxy" layouts, illegible text, inaccessible controls) but also aligns with user expectations shaped by the best of each archetype.

---

[1] [2] Choosing Fonts for Technical Documentation
https://clickhelp.com/clickhelp-technical-writing-blog/choosing-fonts-for-technical-documentation/

[3] [8] [9] [12] [26] [42] Design Teardown of The New York Times – Historian to Software Engineer
https://austinwsmith.wordpress.com/2017/04/25/design-teardown-of-the-new-york-times/

[4] [5] The History of Title Case. Where Did Capitalized Titles Come From? | Reporterzy.info
https://reporterzy.info/en/4852,the-history-of-title-case-where-did-capitalized-titles-come-from

[6] [7] [13] [15] [43] Newspaper Website Design: Trends And Examples — Smashing Magazine
https://www.smashingmagazine.com/2008/11/newspaper-website-design-trends-and-examples/

[10] Welcome to a new look for the Guardian | Katharine Viner | The Guardian
https://www.theguardian.com/media/2018/jan/15/guardian-new-look-online-katharine-viner

[11] Typographic Design Patterns And Best Practices — Smashing Magazine
https://www.smashingmagazine.com/2009/08/typographic-design-survey-best-practices-from-the-best-blogs/

[14] [35] [36] [37] Dark Mode vs. Light Mode: UI Design Considerations and User Preferences | OOZOU
https://oozou.com/blog/dark-mode-vs-light-mode-ui-design-considerations-and-user-preferences-297

16 18 38 39 7 Tips on Embracing Modern Web Design - Logical Media Group
https://logicalmediagroup.com/blog/7-tips-to-make-your-web-design-look-more-modern/

17 19 20 34 Infinite Scrolling: When to Use It, When to Avoid It - NN/G
https://www.nngroup.com/articles/infinite-scrolling-tips/

21 22 23 WebAIM: Skip Navigation Links
https://webaim.org/techniques/skipnav/

24 25 41 How To Design Useful and Usable Focus Indicators
https://www.deque.com/blog/give-site-focus-tips-designing-usable-focus-indicators/

27 BBC Reith Serif in use - Fonts In Use
https://fontsinuse.com/typefaces/103700/bbc-reith-serif

28 Borders & Shadows (Visual Analogies in Data Displays - Part II)
https://www.datarocks.co.nz/post/design-matters-11-borders-shadows-visual-analogies-in-data-displays-part-ii

29 Cards: UI-Component Definition - NN/G
https://www.nngroup.com/articles/cards-component/

30 The Washington Post: a legendary American newspaper
https://www.pixartprinting.co.uk/blog/the-washington-post-a-legendary-american-newspaper/?srsltid=AfmBOooP0v_Ay2KqgNtHaiyl8TCFLdTQ1l2cX6WRYp1NZz_H3eoxbTZU

31 The Typekit Blog | Featured Site: The New York Times
https://blog.typekit.com/2009/12/02/featured-site-the-new-york-times/

32 Open source alternatives to Cheltenham ITC? : r/typography - Reddit
https://www.reddit.com/r/typography/comments/1aisfdr/open_source_alternatives_to_cheltenham_itc/

33 Using Grids in Interface Designs - NN/G
https://www.nngroup.com/articles/using-grids-in-interface-designs/

40 Dark vs. Light Mode: Mobile App Design Best Practices
https://www.dogtownmedia.com/dark-mode-vs-light-mode-in-mobile-app-design-finding-the-right-balance/